It's All Fun and Games Until

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/23044849.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Catra & Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra), Catra & Scorpia (She-Ra), Catra & Entrapta (She-Ra), Entrapta & Scorpia (She-Ra), Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra), Glimmer & Catra & Scorpia & Entrapta (She Ra), Super Pal Trio - Relationship

Characters:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Frosta (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra), Primarily Glimmer and SPT

Additional Tags:
Humor, Crack Treated Seriously, Super Pal Trio (She-Ra), Post-Canon, Post-War, post-redemption, tumblr prompt fic, what is a woman but a miserable pile of weapons wish lists, Bow prevents a multiple homicide daily, Glimmer is 200 percent done, the super pal trio share one brain cell and Glimmer has it 75 percent of the time, additional tags as we go along, Sea Hawk awakens Catra's inner pyromaniac, Scorfuma (background), Adora is a dumb jock, Semi-Chronological, Catra gets the zoomies, Mermista can't take Sea Hawk anywhere, Did somebody say SWIFT WIND!, mild glitradora because that's what happens with two useless lesbians and a disaster bi, Tea Parties and Other Bad Ideas, Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)'s A+ Parenting, Best Friend Squad (She-Ra), Scorpia is Amazing, Catra does the Etherian equivalent of getting her head stuck in an empty mayo jar

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It's All Fun and Games Until

by Nny11

Summary

Glimmer discovers that being the Queen in charge of the reformed Super Pal Trio is a f*cking trip. Follow the SPT as they continuously have to explain themselves to Glimmer.

Notes

For Suricata-Passer on tumblr!

See the end of the work for more notes

Fucktangular

“Can any of you tell me what happened?” Glimmer asked as she was clearly fighting the urge to either scream or take a decade long nap.

The Super Pal Trio looked at one another, and then Entrapta took a deep breath.

“No,” Glimmer preemptively interrupted, “someone who can explain it at my level without confusing herself in the process or being distracted by the inequality of the educational system and the process by which it systematically creates artificial gaps between the classes.”

“Ha ha, okay, so it’s like this,” Scorpia said, nervously clacking her claws together, “We were doing **exactly** what you told us to do, and I mean exactly! When we realized that we could maybe kind of do that **and** also get our quota in you know? So we're getting in the thick of it and-oh man you should have been there it was amazing! Right right, back on task I gotcha, don't need to remind me I am on the case and not stalling for time at aaaaaaall! ...whoooooo boy, anyways that didn’t really work so we then were trying to back track and clean up the mess we made before anyone found out-”

Glimmer held one hand up, the other rubbed at her eyes before turning to look at the final culprit.

Catra, somehow still looking bored despite the way some of her hair was actively smoldering explained, “Things went fucktangular.”

“Well, fuck.” Glimmer groaned, giving the three of them one more look. “How did you three always manage to beat us? You’re disasters when left alone. For literally FIVE MINUTES!”

“Actually, it was only four minutes and twenty three seconds we were alone. So that means we’re improving our efficiency drastically!” Entrapta cheered, bouncing on her hair while high fiving both Catra and Scorpia.

Bow restrained Glimmer by gently grasping her elbow and whispering, “Stay strong for mother.”

Pew Pew Pew!

Chapter Summary

This chapter is brought to you by the word "Terrifunfying" and also Entrapta's inability to /not/ make weapons deadlier.

Chapter Notes

Laser tag!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer took a slow deep breath in, waiting a few seconds before sipping in as much air as possible. Forcing her lungs to expand to full burning capacity, before slamming the throw pillow over her face and screaming.

“Oh come on, this is, like, the least concerning thing we’ve done in at least a few months.” Catra grumbled but to be fair, her slight exhausted smile was a dead giveaway she wasn’t bothered at all.

No, Glimmer could not see her face. She didn’t NEED to see her face to know she was grinning.

Gasping as she finally tossed the pillow away, Glimmer stared incredulously at her. Yup, there was the exhausted smile and a smug eyebrow quirk to boot. Catra was a *dead woman walking*.

“Let me get this straight,” Glimmer started with a firm tone, but knew she would be squeaky and screeching by the end. “In your attempt at rebuilding your friendships with Scorpia and Entrapta, you three fuckers are now meeting daily quotas as set by Entrapta with suggestions from either of them. Is that right?”

“Well-”

Glimmer slapped a hand over Catra’s mouth. “That is a yes or no question.”

Catra nodded, and used the motion to bite her hand before giving her a lick and releasing.

"You are disgusting and I hate you." Glimmer hissed as she wiped her hand clean.

"You love me."

"I tolerate you."

"Way to blow my poor self esteem out of the water again Sparkles."

…Fucking had her there. "I tolerate you, ANYWAYS, as part of this daily quota Scorpia suggested laser tag. A game she's only heard of, and one that neither you or Entrapta have played before. …nod or shake your head, anything else and I teleport you over the lake."

Catra's smile turned into a snort and smirk as she nodded.

Okay, well, mission one accomplished. Make Catra feel better, check. Now if only she could make HERSELF FEEL BETTER.

"Fantastic. So Entrapta," Glimmer looked at the other princess, "you decided to modify some Military Grade **weapons** to play a harmless game?"

"WEEEeeeeeeell I wouldn't say," Entrapta's hair waved vaguely as she twiddled her thumbs, "harmless, it's called laser tag for a reason and lasers (which is actually the correct way to phrase this, any device meant to emit a beam of laser energy are called lasers, gun is just such a ridiculous addition to the nomenclature and I believe scientifically unsound) are meant to injure. I just made sure that the emitter array had a slight adjustment and then had to replace the optical amplifiers because- and that's not even getting into finding a better system to alter the stimulation of radiation to actually form-"

“Why does Entrapta get to ramble but I don’t?” Catra asked, one hand lifted as if waiting to be called on in a class. Something Glimmer was certain the magicat had never ever done in an actual class.

“You tried to destroy the universe.”

“Technically,” Scorpia waved her hand much more enthusiastically, “So has Entrapta. And you! I think I’m the only one who hasn’t. But I did try to help? Am I an accomplice to universal destruction if I was really more of a support net? Do cheer squads ever get in trouble if the team loses? ‘Cause I mean, ha! We have done A LOT of losing and-”

“-which if you think about critically is absurdist in nature, because honestly what is a woman but a miserable pile of weapon wish lists-”

“No, seriously. I don’t get to say anything more?”

“-and there was that time me and Catra were on a **boat**-”

“-the spatial coherence just needed a little tweaking, and re-tweaking after I made it more powerful instead of less. Old habits die hard I’m sure you understand, anyways, the collimation was-”

Glimmer tuned them both out before looking at Catra with a twitching eye. “And you put up with this? For a year?”

“Hey,” Catra actually seemed offended at that, “first of all I was so desperate for attention and scared out of my wits that when Scorpia hugged me I thought she was trying to put me in a headlock and after that first time I almost wished she would have, so I think past me is allowed a few exceptions!”

Glimmer waited, and when no more came out prompted, “And second?”

“Look at them Glimmer, they’re idiots. Helpless without someone, okay? Well, not helpless, but you get what I mean. It would’ve

been like kicking a box of puppies to the curb."

Glimmer did, in fact, physically turn to look at them again.

"-what is wrong with the educational system that students aren't allowed to mess with photolithography these days-"

"-and then I was like, 'if vegetables are so healthy for you why do they taste so sad' and Perfuma said-"

"ENOUGH!" Glimmer screamed loudly enough to be heard and with their attention properly focused back on her, finally got to continue, "No more playing laser tag outside of an official laser tag arena! They have lasers that not only aren't **actual** weapons, but are designed just to trigger the light receivers or whatever the fuck they are called on the vests instead of creating mild sunburns. No more self made laser tag in my castle, got it!?"

There was a pause before Entrapta raised her hand.

"No."

"But I didn't even ask-" Glimmer must have been particularly wild eyed, as Entrapta pivoted to finish, "about…where the…regular arenas…are?"

Catra's tail swished in her peripheral vision with a little too much enjoyment.

"Talk to Sea Hawk." Glimmer moaned as she walked away, unable and unwilling to subject herself to anymore torment.

Only walking faster as she heard Entrapta cackle, "-it'll be terrifunfying!"

Was it too late to decline the throne to Brightmoon? Maybe her dad would want to rule for a bit? Or Bow. Oh, Bow would be amazing at this! She teleported to the kitchen for the ice cream she so rightfully deserves before going to Bow's room to abdicate.

Bow took one look at the containers in her hands before asking, “Are they still alive?”

“Barely.”

All in all it’s a typical Monday afternoon.

Chapter End Notes

> Bow refuses the throne out of principle, but he does take a pint of ice cream as payment for becoming Glimmer's therapist friend.

ADVENTURES IN FIRE (safety)

Chapter Summary

Sea Hawk brings kerfuffle to the floor and sets things on fire. Glimmer is more annoyed she wasn't invited tbh.

Chapter Notes

I am not good at writing songs, enter at your own risk.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The firefighter gave a final nod as they wrapped out their quick report, only pausing to bow after Glimmer signed off. She gave herself three seconds to watch the blaze, now safely contained but improbably still burning hot on the water.

"Can I just say," Scorpia nervously started, "that you are just, uh, looking very queenly today? And did you do something with your hair? It looks, mwah, fantastic!"

Glimmer did not slap her hands over her face, or scream, or generally make a fuss. She was in public after all, and in public she needed to be Queen Glimmer. Powerful. Wise. Unflappable. She turned around, standing as tall as possible with her hands linked over her stomach. "Thank you Scorpia, and no, I did the regular brush and hairspray. Now who wants to tell me what happened?"

The Super Pal Trio looked at one another, despite knowing that Catra was often the best suited for it. Both because she could focus on actually giving facts, and because she was closer friends with Glimmer. Which, really, was just another kick to the knee for the whole situation. Catra rolled her eyes and took a breath, but not quickly enough.

Given a half second of dead air time, Sea Hawk spoke up first.

“Tis a long and valiant tale, your majesty! Involving ADVENTURE and PIRATES and perhaps a minor kerfuffle while playing chubby bunny, but all in the name of pursuing a just cause!” He held one leg up in the air, as if standing on something and waited.

“Oh! Sorry, that’s me!” Scorpia quickly ran and grabbed a boulder to prop under his foot for dramatic effect.

“No.” Catra and Glimmer both commanded at the same time, glancing at each other in slight embarrassment. It was a little like finding out they were wearing the same sweater at an ugly sweater party. Yet neither wanted to back down from their shared stance.

“HA ha! Not to worry ladies, I promise this one will be,” Sea Hawk quickly flattened his mustache dramatically before whipping out a concertina from apparently nowhere, “Painless. *OOOOOOOOOOOOHHHHHHH*!”

Catra grabbed Entrapta’s elbow as she tried to sneak away. “If I have to listen so do you.”

“Aw beans,” Entrapta grumbled.

When you wake in the night

And you’re hollow inside

It means that one must eeeeaaaaat

Glimmer rubbed at her temples, before glaring at the two of them. Scorpia was too busy clacking her claws together along with the beat (okay she was off beat but no one cared) and Bow was playing literal second fiddle. So her options were limited. “No, seriously, what happened? What is that? Why is it **burning in the middle of the palace garden pond** ?”

So you go walk around

Looking all over town

For a tasty friend to meet!

"You ever had a s'more before?" Catra asked only for Entrapta to piggy back instantly with a surprisingly coherent explanation.

"Technically speaking we were following your orders to try playing laser tag again, and you said talk to Sea Hawk, so we did! And on the way to the children's gaming center we discovered that Catra and Scorpia have never had s'mores. That's probably a war crime of some kind-"

Catra's mane and fur bristled up as she squawked, "-ExCUSe yOu!? I will not have my legitimate efforts be lumped with-"

"-which is weird when you think about it, really. I wonder if there is any adjudication regarding it? Would it be adjudication? This isn't exactly my specialty. You know in Dryl we never-"

Glimmer moaned into her hands, "I regret asking."

But when you're craving cocoa

You start to feel loco

And one's fate you cannot cheat!

So go forth to victory, HEY!

OH s'mores, s'mores

More s'mores more!

A sweet delectable treat!

All you need is three

Ingredients

And then you add HEAT!

"This is the worst song I've ever heard," Glimmer sighed, before holding up a hand to stop Catra and Entrapta's one sided argument and unintelligible explanation.

*And what is heat but **fire** ?*

"OKAY EVERYONE STOP! STOP RIGHT NOW!" Glimmer shouted, waving her hands, no longer caring for her public appearance. "Are you telling me, you lit a...a-"

"Boat," Catra supplied while doing a poor job of hiding her smirk.

Of course it was, what else did she think it was. "Of course it was! A BOAT on FIRE in order to make s'mores!? And you didn't even invite me to have s'mores!??!?!?!?"

Everyone looked at Catra who chuckled weakly and waved towards Sea Hawk, who in turn laughed very nervously. "...maybe?"

Even Bow looked affronted, "Do we need to talk about fire safety again?"

Sea Hawk deflated, twiddling his thumbs before mumbling, "I just wanted to look cool, so I offered-"

Catra grumbled, "You failed step one." and was immediately elbowed in the ribs by a glaring Glimmer.

"Hey Buddy, we've talked about this. We have designated fire rings all around just for you. Remember? As long-"

"As it fits I can light it on fire. I completely forgot! Thank you Bow! CREW!.....to the fire pit!" Sea Hawk pointed the way by flexing in its direction. "And can you bring that rock? It's very dramatic and just the right height."

Scorpia laughed, "Of course I do love being involved!"

Glimmer felt the fight drain out of her as she watched them tromp away towards a designated fit pit. She looked mournfully back at the burning hull in her pond and felt a massive headache blooming as she considered how much time it would take to get the burnt remains out once the fire died. Bow gently knocked into her side.

"Soooooooo," He started with a grin.

"Yes! I want s'mores, please, I deserve them and it's my castle so it's my rules!"

Bow cheered loudly as she teleported them both.

Chapter End Notes

> Glimmer has earned whatever she wants for forever considering she deals with these idiots weekly.

Roll With It 2: Electric Boogaloo

Chapter Summary

> Winter's Bane finds a group of new and untested adventurers, and after a long night of intense brooding decides to take them on as apprentices. Our rag tag team of heroes venture forth into the Spider's Lair, where surely nothing will go wro- Adora stop moving the training dummies we're using those. Also you might want to take a few steps back once the fire spells start getting flung around.

Chapter Notes

> This chapter was brought to you by my boss who when prompted for favorite words looked me dead in the eye and said: "Okie-doke. No I don't know how to spell it, but it's a New York thing and [Husband] thinks I made it up cuz I'm from Taos."
>
> I think she wants to spread her vernacular lol! (yes I asked my boss, she's cool okay, don't judge me)
>
> (Yes she knows it's for a fanfic and is fucking thrilled)
>
> ALSO: I can't remember who requested Frosta, please remind me and I'll link ya!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“My liege,” Winter’s Bane stepped forward heavily, the weight of her actions like a cloak of chains pulling her down till she was kneeling. A lodestone around her neck. “t'was my fault, your trusted Grand Knight, Winter’s Bane, for bringing such new adventurers along with us. I accept my fate!”

“Uhm, what? New adventurers!? I did not write six pages of backstory to get hand waved!” C’yra of Purrsia griped in the

background, even if her spell compendium was heavily damaged and pages were falling out with alarming frequency.

"'It makes logical sense though," Entrapta, the cyborg princess, pointed out. "I mean, it's silly to have a bunch of accomplishments and then be level one right? Although if we had gone with my plan to have a simple 5 grinding sessions were we combined our powers to-"

"I totally wanted that by the by!" Erfumpa Beautiful Flower said, one hand waving. "Because then we'd have gotten to use our cool catch phrase, The Power is Yours!"

"That's a stupid catch phrase!" C'yra hissed.

Erfumpa gasped, "You take that back! Winter's Bane helped me come up with it, and it's super cool! Don't be mean, besides we all know you like it."

Winter's Bane felt a twitch in her eye, and lowered her head further before cracking under the need to be say something, "C'yra hates everything."

"I do not!" C'yra waved at her nearly empty spell book. "I like fire magic!"

"Are you four done?" Glimmer pleaded.

Catra glared, hugging her ratty binder close to her chest. Judging by the pages Glimmer could see, she hadn't hole punched them, just jammed them onto the prongs. Whether that was her choice or because she didn't know hole punchers exist was a whole other matter. The pages Glimmer could see had a lot of orange and red ink saying things like "fireball" and "flame blade".

Scorpia clutched at the small bouquet of flowers in her claws, careful not to snip them in two, causing more soil to get knocked out of their roots. She was wearing a flower as a hat, which Glimmer could only assume meant Perfuma had made it just for her. She had apparently opted to simply cover her regular clothes

with a bunch of green bows as a costume but that was better than her friends.

Entrapta was basically just herself. Scratch that, she **was** just herself but with any of the many upgrades safely integrated into her character instead of medically untested and definitely not IRB approved in herself. Hanging from her tool belt, her tracker pad was showing which upgrades went where so she wouldn't forget. She wore one plastic silver bracelet, that Glimmer was pretty sure she'd won in a machine and given to Frosta, to complete her look.

Frosta herself was wearing a modified version of her ice armor, leaving her chest and back exposed to not get too cold. She had one eye squinted dramatically, a fake scar drawn over it in a blue washable marker that had bled a little bit making it look off.

Behind them was the training yard, with all the dummies handily smashed and a few small smoldering spots still visible. Along the walls a disturbingly large amount of robots were crawling, like a tapestry of spiders. Gross.

"Winter's Bane is never done! ...Although, are we not in character anymore? I, uh, this is embarrassing, I can't tell. Wait. Are we in actual trouble? Like, Trouble trouble?" Frosta grinned bashfully. The young teen was still as socially awkward as ever and rarely knew when the line was drawn, but at least her acting had improved over the years.

"Which way will get you all to listen to me?" Glimmer half growled. The 'brave adventurers' looked at one another, and she no longer cared. "You know what? No. No more doing this without prior approval so we can make sure everyone else is out safely from the training grounds. You gave Adora a heart attack with all your screaming and fire spells. Which, now that I'm on it, Catra, how did you do that?"

Catra reached into her loose vest and proudly showed off a small sphere, about the size of a large marble. "Sea Hawk taught me how to-"

Glimmer didn't need to hear anything else. "I will kill him if Mermista doesn't first. Also, I need you to show me so I can ensure to never accidentally make one."

Catra's grin turned absolutely bone chillingly evil. "I knew I liked you Queenie."

"Oh!" Scorpia pointed to the bow's on her arms and Glimmer realized that some were missing. "D'ya wanna see how I do plant magic? Perfuma made them for me, she calls them seed packets and-"

Glimmer tuned out to look around again, but there were no man eating plants to be seen. *Thank the moons!* Only patches of lush tall grass and sunflowers. Honestly those two were so disgustingly sweet she was gonna die. But at least they would be easy enough to replant to the gardens.

"And Entrapta brought the old Horde bots?" Glimmer asked, not caring that she was being rude by cutting Scorpia off. Or, well, attempting to cut Scorpia off. She was apparently rambling more to herself at this point anyways. ("And I was like, 'Whoa!' and she was all cute and giggling and said, 'I know, it's plant magic!' and I almost *died* she's **so cute** -")

"Eeehhhhh," Entrapta wiggled her hand, "they came to see what the fuss was and wanted to play. Also I wanted to test my new fireproofing spray so it was a win-win!"

For one moment she considered the implications that a swarm of spider-like ex-Horde robots was living somewhere in her castle with enough sentientes to wonder what was happening. Where did they live? The Whispering Woods? *The pipes?* Glimmer's skin crawled, and her brain helpfully self shut down to preserve her sanity.

All she had to do now was figure out the best course of action. On one hand, she should be the Queen and ensure the safety of her staff, castle, and guards. On the other hand, she hadn't been

allowed to bash bots, dummies, and more in FOREVER. But was joining them giving them too much leeway? How desperate was she? How badly did she want to banish Catra to cleaning duty again versus how badly did she want to punch things? It was an impossible decision.

"I'm here!" Adora shouted as she skidded around the corner, fully transformed into She-Ra and gasping for air. "I am SO ready to smash some stuff-oh hey Glimmer! Are you playing too?"

Glimmer face palmed. Apparently Adora's breathless, wild eyed exclamation of, "They're *fighting* in the training grounds, with bots and all!" had not been a warning or because she was worried. No. It had been because she had limited time to run to her room and back to join them before missing all the fun.

"You know what?" Glimmer said, making the choice as she spoke. "I am. I am the Evil Twin of Queen Glimmer, and I sparkle!"

Throwing fist fulls of magic at five unsuspecting idiots was just as satisfying as she remembered.

The battle, while small and with all of them vaguely holding back, was amazing. An absolute free for all as they each fought to be the last woman standing.

"That's my tail!" C'yra hissed, holding it with both hands after getting tagged by a sparkle bomb.

"You tried to fucking okie-doke me asshole!" Glimmer hissed right back, after a quick glance ensured Frosta was out of hearing range, pointing at the half destroyed blue cape still hanging from her shoulder. The one Catra had set on fire and thought Glimmer would be distracted allowing her to win. Like there was any winning at larping!

"Oh bite me!"

Adora sent a mostly harmless wave of light over both of them, knocking them on their asses, and Bow shouted, "Glimmer and

Catra you are out!” She wasn’t even sure when he’d arrived but apparently there were referees for larping? Were they still role playing at all? Maybe there was winning…

“Hey, do you think I could set one of these off and make Bow dance?” Catra asked, holding up one of her remaining fire bombs. Her face set in stone at having been called out of the fight.

Glimmer paused, only long enough to grin manically at the idea. She plucked the miniature grenade out of Catra’s hand, pulling back to throw it before telling Catra firmly, “If anyone asks, Entrapta asked us to try it in the name of science. Also I’m the Queen and said it’s okay. Sorry about this Bow, but not too sorry, just sorry enough.”

She’d earned this!

Chapter End Notes

> Yes, Scorpia was RPing her awesome girlfriend. Yes, she also thought she'd been real subtle and slick about it. #bless

They Tried

Chapter Summary

> Catra: Hey, can you send me $300? It's for an escape room.
>
> Glimmer: What escape room costs $300??????
>
> Catra: Jail.

Chapter Notes

> Chapter request by: Somariel
>
> This chapter is brought to you by the words shenaniganry and snickerdoodle.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"It is **over** this time! No more chances!" Glimmer seethed, grip tightening. "I am SICK of them doing this shit!"

"Okay, first of all, ow, that's my hair," Swift Wind nickered, shiny hooves kicking in the air for emphasis. "And second of all, regarding the multiple murder, that's fair."

"Thank you!" Glimmer made sure to loosen her grip, giving him a quick hug around the neck in apology.

The two continued to fly over the Whispering Woods, away from Thaymore where Glimmer *had* been to keep good will alive or something. But when Swifty had arrived bearing a soot stained note from Catra reading simply: *i need 300g for an escape room* , well, Glimmer knew that couldn't bode well at all.

And sure enough, as Swift Wind began his descent, Glimmer could see smoke and fire rising out of a large building of some kind. As they got closer, she realized it said "Etherian Gaming Center". Just

in front of the doors sat the super pal trio and Sea Hawk, being guarded by a few palace guards of all things.

Glimmer teleported the rest of the way and without preamble shouted, “You said for an escape room!”

Catra nodded, pointing with her shackled hands, “Yeah. And jail is, like, the **ultimate** escape room. Except I’m paying to be let out. Duh!”

Swift Wind grabbed a mouthful of Glimmer’s shirt to prevent a fifth person from being arrested.

The guards nervously looked at one another before gamely facing forward in an attempt to look stoic.

Sea Hawk cleared his throat, “Fair and talented Glimmer! Who, may I say, is looking radiant as usual-” A weak sparkle ball to the face cut him off. Sea Hawk nodded sagely. “Honestly? That’s fair.”

“Hey, that’s what I said about killing you guys!” Swift Wind cheered, oblivious to the way the guards were inching closer together, uncertain about what they should be doing with the crown right there.

“That does make sound logical sense,” Entrapta supplied, only pausing to sheepishly put her cuffs back on for the sake of propriety when Glimmer glared at her. “At this rate we’ve probably cost Brightmoon **a lot** of money, but I can refurnish that to you with a reasonable interest rate! Therefore, maybe consider...Not killing us?”

She smiled bright as the day moon, her hair approximated finger guns as she snapped her actual fingers. Although Glimmer noticed that one hand was already free from the cuffs and simply couldn’t bring herself to care.

“... I don’t even know what happened to make that decision yet!” Glimmer growled, checking the back of her shirt for horse drool. When no one answered she snapped, “WELL!?”

“Okay, we were totally doing what you told us to do, like **exactly** , exactly!” Scorpia nervously started to explain, “ I promise there were no plans for shenaniganry! Remember, you said ‘go to Sea Hawk to find out where you can play laser tag’ and we did that! Which was great, we got to ride on his boat for a little, it was amazing! Oh man, there is just something about a life or death situation where you’re nothing more than a little speck with no say in your ultimate fate that’s just so grounding but also exhilarating. The ocean and tides don’t care who you are, they will destroy you. ….oh right! So, after that we all signed up to play laser tag and - OH! Did you know there’s a safety briefing for this? I took some notes if you want them. It’s nothing nearly as crazy as the old Horde drills ya know, but safety third as I always say!”

“Safety first,” Glimmer was almost begging, her whole body slumped in pain, “the saying is safety first.”

Swift Wind stomped a hoof to get her attention, “No, hang on, I think she’s on to something with this. Safety third. SAFETY THIIIIIIIIIRD! I think it has a good ring to it-”

“-which was about the time we made a bet on who could take out the most bots, and let me tell you I was not prepared for the competitiveness-”

“-it just needs a little something to really kick it to the next level, ya know? Saaafety Third! I’m thinking we can-”

“-and I was like, ‘pew pew pew!’ but then Catra just swooped in! Oh man, you should have seen how she dealt with those bots!”

Glimmer could feel a twitch developing *inside* her eyeball. She ignored them in favor of glaring at Catra. “What. Did. You. DO!?”

“Why do people always assume I did something!?” Catra shouted right back.

“BECAUSE SOMEONE JUST SAID IT WAS YOU!”

"-then if anyone asks I can tell them that it's fine, because I'm a trained professional and safety third-"

"WELL MAYBE IT WASN'T ME!"

"-and that's when the backup generator exploded! You'd think they'd have designed these things to handle some serious abuse, I mean, how much could we have really overloaded it?"

"According to my calculations-"

"SCORPIA SAID IT WAS YOU!"

"-which makes us 93.25% more accurate and effective than the regular noobs in the arena-"

"ScORpIa SaID iT was YOU!"

"-which is just so, you know, power of friendship of us-"

Glimmer took a deep breath, trying to calm down right when Sea Hawk raised his own tied hands to say, "Uhm, you're not going to tell Mermista about this are you? Crew code?"

This time it was actually Catra who stopped Glimmer from killing someone, which was strange enough to make everyone finally shut up.

Catra, who used her tied hands to 'hold' Glimmer back, froze up and whined, "Oh this brings back too many memories. I don't like it."

Glimmer could remember the way Catra had done this before as they were swept towards that waterfall and shuddered. She tapped Catra's arm and was freed after a moment.

"Okay. Alright. This is fine. I can figure this out!" Glimmer muttered to herself, looking at the still smoldering building before getting a horrible idea. ".....Entrapta, if I give you access to create a NON-LETHAL and HARMLESS laser tag arena by the

Whispering Woods can you make it able to withstand-" she waved a hand vaguely towards the building, "allllllll of that?"

Entrapta's eyes went wide and very shiny as she threw her hands out, "Are you kidding!? I could make something amaaaaazing with the right resources! OH, I can add a tiny foods snack bar!!"

Scorpia asked hopefully, "Can the chef robot make snickerdoodle ice cream? Because, I mean, c'mon! I'm basically addicted thanks to you!"

Entrapta, however, ignored her. Whether it was an accident or not wasn't clear. "It could be like those old clunky training halls-"

"They weren't clunky!" Catra grumbled, and earned a pat on the shoulder from Scorpia for the effort.

"-but fine tuned for all of our heightened abilities and skills!" Entrapta finished and on seeing Glimmer's exhausted eye twitch slipped her cuffs back on.

"You know what? Fuck it. Sure. I'll parcel it off. I don't care. Come on Swift Wind we're done." Glimmer was more than ready to sleep for a week.

"Uhm, oh shoot!" Scorpia said, having raised her claws and accidentally tore her metal handcuffs into so much scrap. "Sorry, I can fix that! Probably! Uh, but what about us?"

Glimmer hopped on Swift Wind's back, glaring at all of them before looking directly at Sea Hawks' wilted face and mustache. "Put it on Mermista's account."

And with that she took off leaving them to find a way home on their own.

Chapter End Notes

> Don't worry, they'll be so obnoxious that the guards will let them all go pretty fast!

Fan art by Suricata-Passer:



She Just Needs A Hug Okay

Chapter Summary

Glimmer recounts her harrowing trail to Bow and Adora, and receives less sympathy than she'd wanted.

Chapter Notes

This chapter is brought to you be the phrase: Ass Daiquiri

Also, TheBraveThing, this was supposed to be your prompt and then fell completely apart, so I promise yours is next!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora and Bow looked at each other nervously. Bow was able to sit still, arms rigid and locked as he pressed his palms into his knees for grounding, and while he couldn't make his face relax he could feel good about not looking like Adora. Who was tapping her fingers on her arms and booted toes on the floor. Her shoulders tilted in opposite directions to a beat only she could hear as she softly hummed a nervous tuneless set of notes. God they were not made for this shit but they were gonna show up. Because the Best Friend Squad is Ride or Die.

Glimmer stretched sideways over her lounging couch and swirled her wine glass filled with chocolate milk before sighing, "I'm just...so over it you know?"

They knew.

Adora tried to smile brightly, but it was more of an intense sweaty grimace, "Oh yeah! Totally! We know, you know? Of course you know! That we know!? That you know, that we know you're over it-and who can blame you!?!?"

Glimmer huffed another dramatic sigh, taking a long pull from her drink and ending up with a chocolate milk mustache for her

troubles.

Bow rested a hand on Adora's shoulder (who slumped in relief as she was given some instructions which in this case were to stop talking), before speaking, "Well, maybe it would help if you started from the beginning? Walk us through what happened."

The queen of Brightmoon moaned, rolling to be face down on the couch before mumbling something. Bow and Adora looked at one another again, desperate for a direction to take, but Glimmer growled and sat upright. "Fine, so here's what happened."

Glimmer stared down the Super Pal Trio as they sat around a comically small banquet table surrounded by equally small tea cups and pots. She couldn't see anything smoldering or actively on fire, but the smell did still linger. It had to be them!

"What had to be them?" Adora asked, brow quirked and head tilted.

"The guards reported a fire to me, and considering they should have **put it out themselves** I could only assume it was those three again. And I was right. Anyways-"

"Okay-" Glimmer barely started.

*Catra interrupted, pitching her voice obnoxiously in an awful approximation of Glimmer's, "NoW whoooooo WANTS tO tell mE wHaT **happened** ! WE GET IT!"*

"Sweet," Glimmer smiled, "nice to not have to do the whole spiel again. So….fess up bitches."

*"UGH!" Cars groaned, tail flicking in annoyance. A sure indicator that whatever happened was probably her fault. Something everyone was still helping her realize was okay. But also something that Glimmer **would fucking murder her over** .*

"SPT BBP Log, entry 84: It would seem that Queen Glimmer has developed a higher tolerance for-"

"I have not!" Glimmer protested, and after a very long pause she sighed, "Well I didn't mean or want to!"

"You don't even know what she was going to say. Maybe it was going to be flat-"

"Confirmation that Queen Glimmer can deal with more 'bullshit' as the parlance goes or has become less intelligent after prolonged exposure to-"

Glimmer glared at Catra with a twitching eye.

Catra shrugged. "Well I'm not a mind reader."

Adora snorted, face screwing up as she desperately tried to not laugh. Bow gave her an incredulous look and they were both so fucking lucky that Glimmer hadn't noticed.

"Sorry," she whisper wheezed, "I can hear her in my head and it was just really, really funny."

"Supportive Adora!" He whisper squawked back.

"I know! I am! Whoo, okay, deep breath! *Hmmm-haaaaa* . I'm good, I'm ready!"

Glimmer, too wrapped up in her own story didn't notice them not paying attention, lucky they didn't miss anything important.

"Scorpia," Glimmer noted that she had, in fact, gotten better at ignoring background conversations and rambling, maybe this would pay off in some of her logistical meetings, "What happened?"

Scorpia laughed nervously, a large bead of sweat rolling down the side of her face. "Okay, so it started like this. Catra was being open about her childhood for once-"

Bow preemptively kicked Adora's leg to stop her from pouting that Catra hadn't opened up to her.

"-and it was just so sad, and Entrapta said 'you were a ragamuffin' and I said, 'aren't they called ragdolls?'. But I mean, really, Catra doesn't have nearly long enough fur to be part ragdoll, also she's not very snuggly friendly-"

Catra looked like she was wishing for death to take her, not uncommon really, but this time she also looked like she'd begrudgingly accept living so that was a step in the right direction.

"-wait did we? Hang on let me rewind and check…" "-which we did NOT do despite being so close to fully realizing-" "Nope! SO there's still a 32% chance that we-"

"-based just on the striping I'm guessing she's more like a tabby of some kind-OH WHAT IF SHE'S A LIGER!?"

*"You know what," Catra said with a deep sigh, "I'm gonna save us both some misery here. It **was** me, I forgot about the fire bombs I still had in that vest. Did I start the fire? Yes. Did I also put it out right away? Also yes! See, it's fine, can we go now?"*

"Which is just OUTRAGEOUS! Like, that was not a contained blaze! What a **liar**!? I put it out right away my foot! UGH! ...wait, shit, I just realized if they put it out with the little teacups it might have taken a while. They were, like, just bigger than a thimble. Hmmm…well the rose bushes won't be the same regardless. Anyways so me and Catra started this whole nonverbal thing-"

An eyebrow lifted for disbelief. A dismissive flick of a tail. Glimmer used both hands, pushing forward before spreading them out to encompass all the bullshit. Catra rolled her eyes and put her hands on her hips because really? Really? Glimmer's mouth bunched to one side as she struggled to not scream since it's true this was not about all the bad things they'd ever done. Catra motioned to her now ruined vest, something she'd become overly fond of wearing by itself no matter how many times Glimmer begged her to wear something under it.

Look, there are too many women loving women in Brightmoon for her to allow someone as naturally hot as Catra to walk around wearing nothing but a vest and tastefully torn pants. Especially if she was going to insist on not wearing a bra.

Oh by the moons, this was getting out of hand!

So Glimmer took a deep breath, lifted one hand to get everyone's attention before pointing at the true culprit of the hour, and said, "Catra, your ass-daiquiri bullshit aside-"

Only to have her grand speech instant interrupted.

"I didn't know you could make an ass flavored daiquiri. Who orders that? Are they okay?" Scorpia asked planting the seeds of an awful vision in Glimmer's mind.

Entrapta raised a hand, "Question, when you say ass flavored do you mean the buttock or the anus because I think-"

Bow turned a little green and shifted uncomfortably in his seat. "Gross."

"Right!?" Glimmer wailed, and then immediately took another swing of her chocolate milk. A big swing. Damn.

"Do you see what you've done?" Catra asked, dead eyed and looking like she'd aged thirty years. "Do you understand how many more times I am going to be stuck hearing about this shit? I'm sorry, no matter what happened earlier ***you*** *are now the one in trouble."*

"...fucking fair I guess." Glimmer sighed wishing she could scrub this all from her memory.

"No, no, no! No blowing this off! Listen to this shit!" Catra pointed emphatically at her friends.

And like a woman going to her own execution, she accepted her punishment.

"-because I really can't picture who would enjoy it, I mean, don't get me wrong a rump roast that's been cooked just right is-"

"I suppose the intergluteal cleft could technically count as it's own part, but I'm assuming a flavor profile-"

"-with a little butter and perfect! Oh MAN I am really hungry now!"

"-note to self: chemical reaction between-"

"OH NO, is this a cannibalism thing!? Is this how you become a cannibal because-"

"I suppose I do understand why educators wouldn't want certain volatile compounds left in the hands of their students, but I am a professional so it was kind of rude-"

"-and then what if I start craving it? Perfuma is going to hate me, and then I'm going to die alone. Oh I'm doomed. DOOMED!"

Glimmer gave Catra a hangdog look, desperate for a reprieve. She couldn't do this, this was awful! Yes, she'd made a mistake but it was an honest mistake!

*Catra, being the **monster** she is, didn't budge. Only folded her arms and glared back, her tail twitching a mile a minute behind her in agitation. It was a long, looooooooong afternoon after that.*

"And that's what happened and I'm too beautiful for this! I'm a good person!" When her friends both made so-so motions with their hands and shrugged, Glimmer rolled her eyes and tried again, "I'm often a good person and also the queen so what I say should go- not to totally abuse my powers here but you know- and also I've never done anything wrong in my li-high-hi ffffff!"

Bow rolled his eyes at her dramatic fake sobbing, hands pressed together in front of his face as he took a deep breath.

Glimmer gave a particularly pathetic whimper, "I want to die."

Bow exhaled in a large whoosh of air, before pointing with both his hands at her. “Harsh but understandable. Although perhaps you should be forced to live and deal with the consequences.”

Glimmer kicked her feet weakly and whined, “Can I at least get a hug please?”

Bow gave a fake smile, and Adora lost it laughing before he even opened his mouth. “Oh, sorry! Wish I could!”

“Is this because I used fire bombs on you? Still? That was like, two weeks ago!” Glimmer knew she was pushing her luck here, but she was just too tired to try hard at anything ever again.

Bow snorted. “You are very lucky that I love you.”

Glimmer still had to get up and throw her whole body sideways at them, trapping them and refusing to get up until she got a hug. And then another. And eventually Adora just picked her up with one arm and stood up to get back to work. A little more whining convinced her to pick Bow up in her other arm and carry them both back down towards the library.

Chapter End Notes

Adora is strong like ox, and I love her so much.

Just a reminder, send me your prompts and favorite words/phrases to help me get more crack written! :D

Deleted Scene:

Glimmer, "And I've done nothing wrong in my life ever!"

Adora, "We know this, and love you."

Bow, can't talk because he's both wheezing and laughing.

What We Have is You (Ew)

Chapter Summary

> The Princess Alliance spends a night out at a karaoke bar to relax and unwind, too bad stupid Catra had to sing her stupid song so stupidly sexy and now they can't go back for at least a month.

Chapter Notes

> This chapter is brought to you by AJ fucking destroying every wlw and many, many queer men with Warriors. Fuckin' rude.
>
> Prompt was mutilated beyond recognition for TheBraveThing , but Glimmer did incite violence!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"And up next we haaaaaave Perfuma!" Netossa dramatically announced, eyebrows waggling as she waited. Perfuma, three drinks in, shook her head and slid down in her seat. "I didn't- I didn't sign up!"

"Oh I know." Netossa snickered. "You were voluntold girl, get up here!"

"Fucking- do we really want to hear Flower Power drunk singing?" Catra groused, feet kicked up on the table *again* .

Glimmer shoved them back to the floor... *again* . "Don't be, wait, okay be *less* mean."

Catra whined, slumping face first onto the sticky table's surface. "I'll die!"

"Then perish," Glimmer hissed, "and do it quietly! Look at Scorpia, do you want to upset her?"

There was a long pause where Catra grumbled several unintelligible things to herself before looking up at Scorpia's grinning face. "Yeah! Woo! Go Perfuma! Oh she is just so talented!!"

"Ugggghhhh, nooooooo?" Catra groaned, slapping her hands over her ears in preparation.

Perfuma held the mic in a slightly wobbling grip but her voice was steady and sure as she sang directly to her girlfriend. Scorpia, of course, burst into tears after the very first line.

You fill up my senses, like a night in the forest

Like the mountains in springtime, like a walk in the rain!

Like a storm in the desert like a sleepy blue ocean,

You fill up my senses, come fill me again!

Glimmer kicked at Catra's knee under the table as the ex-captain fake gagged. "If you hate it so much you can just leave!"

Catra's eye twitched as she lifted her left hand, the one Entrapta had handcuffed to the table when Catra had tried to slink away an hour ago.

"...fucking fair. More alcohol?"

Catra's eye twitch got worse as she motioned to all of herself. At Glimmer's confused stare, Entrapta jumped in, "Catra's physiology is unique amongst the Princess Alliance thanks to her more feline genetics. While there have, thus far, been no longer term studies it is believed that-"

Glimmer mouthed ‘sorry’ to the one literally captive audience member.

Let me give my life to you

Come let me love you

Come love me again

You fill up my senses-

“-and renal failure is highly likely, but that’s besides the point! How do they ‘know’ that if there haven’t been any long term studies? I’m telling you the ethics boards are just afraid to expand their horizons and furthermore-”

“That’s my girl, look at her, oh wow, I am crying over here!”

Glimmer managed to tune everyone out rather well actually. She gracelessly shoved her way to sit between Entrapta and Catra and offered, “Maybe I can get some tissue paper? You can make ear plugs? I want you to suffer, don’t get me wrong, but I’m not trying to torture you.”

“You know what?” Catra started, face completely sour and scrunched, “Why don’t you take your obnoxiously sugary friends and-”

“Catra! You’re up!” Netossa announced amongst the remaining scattered applause.

Glimmer held her hands up quickly to prove she hadn’t done anything, despite having helped the super pal duo set this all up, and Entrapta, not having paid attention but recognizing a sign that her furry friend was near meltdown, did the same.

“No.”

“Aw,” Scorpia whined, instantly outing her part in the scheme, “but Catra you’ve got such a pretty singing voice!”

“Wait, wait, you’ve HEARD CATRA SING????” Glimmer rocked forward in her seat.

“Scorpia…”

“Oh yeah! Sometimes late at night I’d listen to her singing in the locker room-”

“I swear by Hordak’s tits I will fucking kill you-”

“-and she can just really bring that depth of emotion to a song, even if the songs are all-”

“Scorpia!”

“-clearly, and I mean don’t get me wrong I get it, but like break up songs-”

“HEY!” Catra’s scream got everyone’s attention as she lifted her shackled hand. “Who wants to exact revenge on a willing and helpless victim? I need someone to shoot me right now.”

“Nice!” Glimmer lit up a fist only to have Adora grab her from behind. “I was kidding! Mostly!”

Netossa sighed into the mic before walking over to their table. “Sorry kid, you still gotta live with your shit. Now pick a song, here’s the mic, let’s do this.”

“You’re not my mom!”

“Don’t threaten me with a good familial time pal, you know Spinnerella has adoption papers *lined up* and *ready to go* , try me bitch.”

Catra spent a half second glaring her down before grabbing the behemoth binder out of her hands to find a song.

Glimmer, still being restrained by Adora and with her body just slightly lifted out of her chair jeered, "Oooooooo, someone's in trouble!"

Sea Hawk laughed far too loudly, his mustache a frizzy mess as he swayed in his seat. Mermista, still nursing her first fish bowl drink groaned and slid down almost under the table to avoid any looks shot their way.

Catra jabbed her finger at a song and Netossa grinned. "You got it."

Adora finally lowered Glimmer back into her seat, but didn't really let go so much as flop on her before asking, "What're you singing?"

"Why don't you shut up and find out?" Catra grumbled.

"Hey, don't be mean, I can lean on you too!" Adora half offered, half threatened.

Before she could do anything the countdown started and the sound of a very dramatic piano kicked in. Catra started singing almost instantly, voice smooth as silk and slightly breathy immediately demanded attention.

We're warriors, unstoppable, ooooooooh

"Oh shit," Glimmer wheezed.

We feel the evil comin'

And shadows all around

Danger surrounds us

But won't bring us down

"Oh fuck," Glimmer whispered with a lot of feeling.

Catra winked at her, and Glimmer was pretty sure she died.

We're on the edge of greatness

Turning darkness to light

We're right beside you

Ready to fight

"I'm too gay for this," Glimmer concluded right as Adora helpfully added, "Uhhhhhh."

Catra threw her head back dramatically gripping the mic with two hands, oh what the fuck, what the actual fuck, this was unfair! This was, this was just cruel and unusual! Glimmer was trapped with a very buff warrior still clinging to her and a very lithe warrior who was, apparently, allowed to sing that good.

"I played myself," Glimmer said softly. Signing Catra up to sing had been the worst choice she'd made in weeks.

We must be strooooooong

We must be braaaave

We gotta find every bit of strength that we have

And never let it go!

"You sabotaged us," Adora groaned, burying her face in Glimmer's hair, "why would you do this, I thought we were friends?"

"I'm...I'm so sorry," Glimmer mumbled as the drums kicked in.

We must be strong (strong)

We must be brave (brave)

We gotta find every bit of strength that we have

And never let it goooooooooooo!

"Is that...is that legal?" Bow asked, eyes squinted as he stared unblinking. "Is that allowed? Is she allowed to do that?"

Entrapta accidentally bumped him with her secondary recorder. "Subjects appear, what I've been informed the cool kids call, shooketh."

We're bound to this struggle

With mighty sword and flame

We'll never fail you

When you call our name

Glimmer, Adora, and Bow all slowly turned to look at Entrapta. "...subjects appear very interested in me?"

"You set me up," Glimmer gasped, "I can't believe you'd play me like this!"

There was a pause before Entrapta smiled brightly, "You can just consider it payback! Ahaha!"

"What the fuck? What the fuuuuuuck?"

Together we'll be heroes

Joining forces as one

Adora squawked as Catra winked at **her** this time.

Strong as the steel we carry

We rise like the sun!

"Yup," Scorpia mused with a nostalgic air, still happily nuzzled into Perfuma's side, "just as good as I remember."

"Cheers!" Perfuma added, clicking her empty water glass on Scorpia's shoulder chitin.

We must be strong (strong)

We must be brave (brave)

We gotta find every bit of strength that we have

And never let it goooooooooo!

We must be strong!

The guitars were dreamy and Catra was eating up the now very positive attention. Only frowning as she tried to put her hand out dramatically and the shackle clanged around a bit.

'Cause we're warriors

We're unstoppable

Nothing's gonna get in our way

(Oooooooh, oooooooh, oooooh, oooooh)

Catra tilted her head to make as much eye contact with Glimmer and Adora as she more spoke than sang, " *We're gonna win in the eeeeend.* "

We must be strong (we must be strong)

We must be brave (we must be brave)

We gotta find every bit of strength that we have

And never let it go! (let it gooooo!)

We must be strong (we must be strong)

We must be brave (we must be brave)

We got our ancient sights

Stand together and fight

And never, let it go

We must be strong…

Where there would have been a stunned silence was instead Scorpia and Perfuma cheering while Glimmer and Adora tried to pull their jaws off the floor. Bow patted them both on the back and tried to console to the best of his limited abilities.

"Glimmer, you earned this. Adora...you probably also earned this. Congrats?"

"Bow!" Glimmer gasped.

"What!? It's true!"

"Yeah, no, he's got a point," Adora nodded. "Hey Entrapta? Next time just shoot us okay?"

"You got it! Log 394, Subject: Adora, I have been given explicit permission and instruction to-"

"She's being facetious!" Glimmer cried. Then elbowed Adora in the ribs when her response was to give an unconvinced, "Ehhhh."

"Addendum to log, I believe Adora has used sarcasm for the first

time with me. Exciting development! ...but also, just for the record can I-”

“No.” Catra cut in. “If anyone gets to gets a mercy killing first, I claim dibs.”

“NOBODY IS KILLING ANYBODY JUST BECAUSE OF SOME SEXUAL TENSION!” Glimmer shrieked and instantly regretted every life choice that led up to this very moment, as the entire Princess Alliance stared at her in silence.

Frosta raised her hand, “What’s sexual te-”

“Changed my mind, as the Queen I get the first mercy killing. Go for it.”

Catra kicked at her under the table, “I called dibs!”

“I have the authority!” Glimmer hissed and kicked back.

“Get in line Sparkles! Me, you, and then Adora!”

Adora raised her hand, “Okay, so I know what sex is, but sexual tension is, like, when-”

“She can get us both with one hit, be logical!” Glimmer growled with another kick.

“Fuck you, I’m not sharing!” Catra’s kick went wild, meeting with poor Bow’s shin.

Causing him to spit his drink out, covering Entrapta who’s recorder fritzed and shocked her. Which made Catra leap up with a legitimate hiss of fear, that Glimmer heard as a cue to fight. So Glimmer lit her fist again and teleported to throw a punch very happily ignoring whatever that snarled mess of tangled emotions she’d just experienced was.

Thirty minutes later found them all outside the karaoke bar as the owner glared them all down.

Netossa threw her hands in the air, “We didn’t even do anything!”

“Banned.” The owner insisted one more time. “One month ban.”

“But, good sir ma’am!” Sea Hawk slurred, an arm wrapped amicably around the owner’s neck. “Have you considered-”

“Begone thot!” They shouted, pushing Sea Hawk into Mermista’s arms.

“I, like, literally can’t take you anywhere.” She groaned to her very drunk boyfriend.

Glimmer slapped her hands over her face and growled. She just got herself and every royal in a several mile range banned from the one good karaoke bar. She had a pretty good feeling that she might be assassinated before their next big group outing, which only seemed fair.

Chapter End Notes



(Image lovingly made by Nam Nam Munch Much , and then totally jacked by me)

Also, why yes, that was a Kipo reference. And then Glimmer saw Catra sing and said, "Nah I'm good, I don't want to sing after that. Thanks."

You know. Like PWAH!

Chapter Summary

Glimmer is woken up nightly by someone having a case of the zoomies. Some s5 spoilers contained!

Chapter Notes

Brought to you by the word zoomies!

Also I was an idiot and didn't write down who suggested this in my google doc. :| So whoever it was please tell me and I will add you on here! (And I'm sorry, and I love you!). dragonesdepapel had requested Glimmer causing violence and being scolded by Bow and Adora. Last chapter was the instigating violence, this is the gets scolded one. :p

CW: for very brief description/talk about child abuse

It's not my fault Shadow Weaver was who she was alright!?

SKKKITZERAFRACKRACKBANGSKITZZZZ

Glimmer shrieked, instinctively teleporting at the extremely loud awakening. "Whasdf!?"

Nothing in her room was even a hair out of place. Weird. She-she had just heard an unholy-

BAMKISSSSSSHHHKERPOWSKKITZZBANG C R A S H

In the hallway Glimmer found a few pieces of armor and Catra who was laying more against the wall as the only thing on the floor was her head and neck. A helmet was stuck on her head as she clawed at it with her feet, tail lashing wildly around and poofed up to the max. Glimmer snorted. It was cute, okay!? Like, three times it's normal size easily!!!

There was a muted growling and hiss followed by Catra blindly thrashing around and knocking into the other armor pieces.

"Stop! You're gonna-" Glimmer tried to sound authoritative, but as soon as Catra managed to jump, then jump off the wall *mid* previous jump, only to roll and struggle with the helmet again the jig was really up. "PPPPfffffffft!!!!"

It took her a minute to stop wheeze laughing, but she finally managed to offer, "Hey, calm down I can get that-"

Catra dashed away on all fours, a loud clang sounding around the corner as she smashed into a wall before skittering into the darkness.

She took one last look at the scratched and dented pauldron and gorget sitting innocently enough on the floor, before retreating to her room. It was ass o'clock and Catra being a massive dumbass was not her problem. It took a while, what with her having a few last giggling fits (it had been sooooo puffy!) before relaxing enough, but she did get back to sleep.

The problem was that the very next night, it happened again.

"WAUGH!" Glimmer screamed, rolling and teleporting. Landing on her feet with her staff ready to smash a bad guy in the **face**.

BANG

Her door flew open and Catra came tumbling through, looking just as lost and confused as Glimmer felt. She shook her head and looked around, eventually noticing Glimmer there with her staff, and Catra's pupils blew so wide there was almost no color left. Her tail poofed up wildly, and even the fur on her shoulders fluffed.

"...are...are you okay?" Glimmer asked, slightly worried and slightly amused.

Catra opened her mouth only to get hit in the face by her own tail. Scaring her so badly that she squeak shrieked, popped in the air a good five feet before crashing back down, and chased her own tail. Which was the single best thing Glimmer had ever witnessed until Catra slammed face first into the open door with another loud crack.

"ARE YOU OKAY?" Glimmer dismissed her staff and began running over, that sounded like a broken nose at least!

Only Catra fluffed up, somehow miraculously, worse and took a swipe at her before fleeing down the hallway again.

She wasn't sure how long she stood there, but when she did finally check the time it flashed a depressing 2:24 in the morning. Gross. With a groan she shut her door and got back on her bed. If Catra was gonna be weird and run away fine, Glimmer was too tired to care.

But, see, the thing is the next night-

SNICKSNACKSCRATCCCCCH

"I will fucking kill her!" Glimmer tore her bed sheets off and hopped down the steps to rip her door open.

Catra fell face first onto the floor, Melog hit her chest and transformed into an indistinct blob. And honestly? Glimmer would have accepted that Catra was dicking with her for three nights in a row. But Melog? No! Melog was a good and precious baby girl!

So if she was a hot mess too, then it meant Catra was actually having a problem.

For all that Glimmer actually **did** care she was exhausted and all she could manage was a single, "Well shit."

Catra lay still on the floor clutching at her face, rolling onto her back and wiggling as Melog mournfully yowled. Oh yeah, she had smashed her nose last night too hadn't she? Glimmer grabbed them both, one by the arm and the other by it's mind twistingly ever changing shape and teleported them to the outskirts of the whispering woods.

"Stay!"

Another few poofs and sparkles later found Glimmer, still exhausted and in her PJs, and Entrapta who looked like she had just woken up.

"-what I mean is how far is your limit? Do you know? What happens if you try to go past? Can you end up in rock or missing limbs!?"

Glimmer groaned, couldn't even care as Entrapta caught a few sparkle samples, and pointed. Catra had started almost bouncing off the trees and Melog was...well, at least she was almost cat shaped again.

"Oooooh," Entrapta said, as if suddenly everything in the world made sense. From one of her pockets, her hair pulled out a red laser pointer and put the dot right in front of Catra's face. Catra who stopped dead in her tracks, tail slowly swishing as she hunkered down and watched. Glimmer tried to speak up only for another few strands of hair to cover her mouth. Crouched on the ground, hands between her feet, Catra lowered her head, wiggled her butt, and pounced; coming up with handfuls of grass and soil as Entrapta flicked the laser up a tree. Which Catra zipped right up, tearing the poor thing's bark and side to shreds; jumping tree to unfortunate tree as she followed the dot.

Right up until her and Melog collided with one another. And then hissed at each other.

Entrapta skillfully ran the laser between them to catch their attention before sending them on a wild run.

"Huwa uh oock?" Glimmer asked, spitting a little as the hair pulled away and out of her mouth

"Oh yeah, sometimes when Catra doesn't get enough enrichment she gets what Scorpia called," Entrapta pulled out her recorder, expertly rewinding to play Scorpia's voice. " *Oh yeah she just, you know, ZOOM, ha ha! Isn't that great, man she is just so talented! OH- let's call them zoomies!"* Entrapta spoke in time with her recorded self, "Sure, that tracks."

Glimmer watched as both cats toppled over one another again before Melog took off like a shot leaving Catra panting on her back. "Okay, so she's not...what? Exercising enough?"

"Mmmmmeeeehh," Entrapta wiggled a hand, "exercise and fighting are definitely good outlets, but she also might just be bored out of her gord and not taking necessary steps to cure that out of wanting to 'not look like a dweeb' as she would say."

Catra slowly peeled herself off the ground, hunched over as she turned to watch Melog crash face first into a bush. Shaking her whole body to free up some of the dirt she'd rolled around in, Catra drug her feet as she went to stand with Glimmer and Entrapta. There was a a genuine casualness to how she crossed her arms and popped a hip out. Which only made it worse when she said, "Sup."

"Are you kidding me?" Glimmer groused.

"What!? I can't control it!" Catra hissed, tail wrapping around her waist.

"Is that **really** your excuse for fucking up my sleep schedule?"

“Oh no,” Catra smirked, “that was by design, but the energy thing? Nah. Don’t you ever just PWAH!”

Catra spread her fingers wide almost like she was pantomiming an explosion.

“No!” Glimmer shouted, then after a split second to fully think through what she’d been told squawked, “Hey!”

“Seriously? You’ve never just, like, gone for a 10 mile run at three in the morning?”

Glimmer could only try to picture that moment, what would cause her to willingly run 10 miles instead of teleporting. “No!”

“Huh, weird,” Catra seemed genuinely confused by that, before shrugging. “Yeah, back when the biggest thing about me was my hair, sometimes I’d slip out and just run the track for a while. If I was lucky Adora would join and we’d race each other, and then we’d both get in so much trouble the next day! Ha! Well, I mean, Adora would be told to watch her sleeping habits and Weaver would keep me up a few days BUT worth it!”

“Catra, no.”

“What?”

When Glimmer just looked at her sadly Catra scrunched her nose in thought. “Oh. Well, it was.”

“That’s fucked up dude.”

“Meh,” Catra wiggled her hand and waved when Melog whipped around to find her, before running after the laser again, “It wasn’t that bad.”

“That’s child abuse!”

“We’re talking about the same Shadow Weaver right? The one who went out doing what she loved? Abusing children?”

Glimmer pinched the bridge of her nose. There was no working through that trauma at whatever time it was just because Catra chased a laser pointer. "You know what? Later. When we're more awake and I have Bow and Adora and Scorpia-"

"H-hey, wait!"

"-and Perfuma and Sea Hawk and-"

"Fucking!? Don't you dare!!!"

"-don't even know *how* I'll find Razz but I will and then we are gonna **dog pile you, you stupid cat**."

"I can't believe this, I thought we were friends! How dare you-" Catra was cut off as Entrapta flashed the laser onto her Catra's hand. There was a loaded pause as Catra's pupils blew wide open again. She took a swipe at it, missed, hissed, and then was off like a bolt.

"...ugh, that could've gone better." Glimmer muttered.

But Entrapta just shrugged, "It could've gone a lot worse too! She took that much better from you than she ever did from Scorpia. Fascinating!"

Glimmer growled into her hands before slapping herself twice across the face, and in her most calm and put together voice asked, "Can I get a laser from you?"

Two weeks later, that turned out to be a very bad idea.

Bow's mouth hung wide open as he looked around, Adora huffed an annoyed sigh even as Perfuma sobbed a pitiful, "Whhyy!?"

against one of the destroyed trees.

“Okay,” Bow took a slow deep breath and Adora and Perfuma got to work, and then rounded on them, “Who wants to tell me what happened?”

Catra snickered, watching with delight as Glimmer tried to sink into the planet’s core. Entrapta opened her mouth only to get cut off.

“Entrapta, I love you. You are a dear friend to me, but I also know this wasn’t your idea...you were an enabler which is why you’re here.” Bow pointed with both hands pressed together before turning to the other two culprits.

“Ooooh, doesn’t feel so good does it Sparkles?” Catra whispered giddily.

Glimmer sighed, scrubbed at her face, and then did her best. “Okay, so, here’s the thing-”

It turned out that she was just as bad as any of the Super Pal Trio at explaining things.

Catra was sentenced to a daily exercise regime which Adora was a bit too eager to help her with and three days a week having a study session with Bow. Which was light when compared to Glimmer honestly.

“You can’t ground me!” She gasped.

Bow stared her down, “Now it’s two weeks and no ice cream. You wanna keep going? I can do this all day.”

“Bow!”

“Two weeks and no desserts period.”

Glimmer gasped, tears in the corner of her eyes, “You monster!”

“YOU DESTROYED THE WHISPERING WOODS GLIMMER! How can you sleep at night!?” There was a long pause before Bow’s eye twitched. “Glimmer. Glimmer don’t you dare-”

“Like. A. Baby!”

Adora restrained him by the arm and groaned, “No! Bow, do you wanna be the ruler of Brightmoon?”

“I have suffered *enough* ,” He moaned before jabbing a finger at Glimmer, “Fine, two weeks no desserts, and afterwards you still have to be the responsible queen.”

Which, really, was its own punishment.

Strawberry Shortcake, Blueberry Pie...

Chapter Summary

> Lynda and Terra reunite at last, Melog is a little shit, Madam Razz vibe checks Catra, and Bow experiences his villain origin story.
>
> Honestly, this is par for the course.

Chapter Notes

> Smithereens, I would like to formally apologize because I swear the outline was Madam Razz and Perfuma teaming up on Glimmer and Catra. But, then, like, Perfuma refused and Glimmer went rogue and then everyone wanted to be evil again and it kinda got out of hand.
>
> Sorry! But also! I hope you enjoy the insanity!
>
> And yes, Melog is She/He/They and my non-binary ass will die on this hill.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

The Whispering Woods had regrown before Glimmer's sentence was up, looking pristine once more. But Perfuma had declared that none of them had a true respect or appreciation for nature (except Scorpia, who was an angel that she was thrilled to have there), and as such she was going to take them into the woods to forge a deeper bond with the planet.

It had kind of devolved from there.

Adora and, of all people considering her new relaxed attitude in life, Catra had packed like they were going on a military march with three sets of clothes bundled in what Glimmer was certain was physically impossibly small tubes. They had two liters of water each, MREs, emergency heat blankets, water purifiers, and

had their sleeping rolls stored under their matching gray rucksacks. The only difference seemed to be that Adora brought a utility knife and flint, while Catra brought a map and compass. Scorpia had arrived with a large floral printed bag with her and Perfuma's supplies, but on seeing her two friends she'd laughed.

"Oh man, classic survival packing! Where did you even find two of those ugly rucksacks? I thought they'd been repurposed." But when Catra and Adora had just looked at each other in complete confusion Scorpia had snickered. "Aw, don't worry about it! Very professional looking!"

Glimmer had her old Rebellion travel pack, which she had not packed efficiently considering they were only spending one night in the woods for a weekend retreat. Entrapta, who had brought nothing, yet always seemed to have a dizzying array of measuring tools, had been scuttling circles around them as she...did whatever it was she was doing. Taking samples maybe? Entrapta's cackle echoed hauntingly around them. Glimmer took a few subtle steps to stand closer to her friends. Creepy as *fuck* ...FOR SCIENCE!

Even Melog had dutifully trudged alongside Catra, although they weren't burdened with any gear. They had been about to leave them when Catra dragged them bodily out of the castle seething that everyone had forgotten Melog is, in their own words, " *A sentient little shit who gets away with it by playing dumb* ."

They spent almost three hours just hiking to the grove Perfuma had in mind, and she allowed another hour for them to set up before pulling them all back to a warm up drumming circle which included Scorpia playing a tambourine (" *It's the claws, if my concentration isn't perfect I just punch right through. So this is a lot easier! And, also, listen to that sound- oh! I love it, I could listen to that all day!* ") and Melog meowed out a hauntingly beautiful series of notes. It ended when Adora and Catra somehow found a way to make drumming a competitive sport, which had been amazing and she may or may not have encouraged them.

When Perfuma turned her narrowed gaze on her, Glimmer smiled and shrugged, after all, it *was* still Adora and Catra.

The rest of the day was spent learning about mindfulness before spending hours on hours silently being mindful and occasionally silently meditating to connect with nature. Had she mentioned the silent part? Painfully silent. Not even getting to say a word as Melog clearly fell asleep and Catra looked two seconds from screaming.

Or at least, mindful meditation had been the plan.

Around hour five of the trip, Glimmer had snuck a peak to see if everyone else still had their eyes closed, only to come face to disturbingly close face with an old woman. Correction, an ancient woman with terrible breath eating blueberries.

"AH!" Glimmer teleported backwards in surprise, but only after flailing and nearly tumbling ass over hat.

Everyone else sprung into action, up and magic powers primed. Catra had unsheathed her claws and snarled towards the potential threat. Which almost made up for Glimmer over reacting. Adora lowered her fists first with an equally exhausted but fond smile.

"Oh, hello Madam Razz," Adora waved.

"Hello dearie," Madam Razz waved back with her berry stained hand, "I thought I'd check to make sure everyone was alright. It was so quiet! And I've never seen any of you so still."

"We were meditating," Perfuma smiled and waved to a free spot, "would you like to join us?"

"Do I know you?" Madam Razz squinted at them suspiciously.

Glimmer elbowed Catra hard when she muttered a surly, "What the fuck?"

She might not really 'get' Razz, but she did respect the old woman immensely for her powers, her dedication, and her willingness to try and brow beat Adora into self love. Moons knows none of them had mastered that last one.

"Actually, no! I don't think we've met. I'm Princess Perfuma from Plume-"

Madam Razz waved her broom around. Wait when had she gotten her broom? "Yes, yes! Alder I would recognize you anywhere!"

Perfuma chortled, charmed and patient as could be; for now. "Alder was my father, I'm Perfuma."

"Who?"

Adora made significant eye contact with her, and Glimmer sighed heavily before asking, "What can we do for you Madam Razz?"

Razz didn't answer, instead opting to check out some of the drums Perfuma had brought before finding one apparently not to her liking. Well, that's what Glimmer assumed when she began to hit the thing with her broom creating a pleasant dum-tish sound.

Catra rolled her eyes before muttering, "Crazy old coot."

Here was the thing, Glimmer was here because she'd been in trouble. In fact, Bow had bemoaned that the longer she spent chasing the Super Pal Trio down the more and more trouble she seemed to be in. Which was almost like saying she was anything like Catra. No. No thank you. Glimmer willfully had pushed any recognition of that being vaguely true deep down, and decided she needed to stop herself from becoming *more* like Catra in any way shape or form. And she did actually feel supremely bad after listening to Perfuma talk about the pain of the trees. So she'd actually come on the retreat fully intending to give it a genuine effort. To silently exist with the planet; the flora and fauna and magic. To find a new connection or appreciation for their protector; the Whispering Woods. She didn't even do it because it

was Bow's home, Glimmer wanted to because she felt genuinely bad.

And she knew that as soon as she opened her mouth, she was throwing all of that aside just to be a dick to Catra.

...

Worth it.

"Actually, Madam Razz, I was hoping to introduce you to Catra!" Glimmer said, slinging an arm around her frenemy's stiff shoulders.

"What the fuck do you think you're doing?" Catra hissed at her as she wiggled and struggled to get away without looking like it and getting sentenced to a second weekend in the woods.

Glimmer smiled as benevolently as she could, "She's new to the whole existence isn't a curse and life isn't a prison thing. I've been trying to help her realize that life isn't a party where she's the pinata, and thought you might have some advice."

Catra stopped her half assed escape attempts and glared, hand pressed over her heart, "You fucking traitor!"

Glimmer tightened her arm around Catra's furry little neck and hissed through her smile, "I warned you about Madam Razz, Horde Scum. I warned you bro."

Razz, for her part, adjusted her glasses critically before walking over. There was a long pause as she looked up at Catra who was doing her level best to not growl. And then she promptly began hitting Catra's knees with her broom. "YOU! Razz-le! Dazz-le! Razz-le! Dazz-le!"

Adora scooped the old woman up by her armpits, her tattered dress flapping in the breeze and giving them all an unfortunate look at her panties. Meanwhile, Glimmer practically had to put Catra in a joint lock to prevent a murder.

“No respect!” Madam Razz shouted before throwing her broom and knocking Entrapta out of the trees. “Neither of you! No respect for the woods!”

“Yes!” Perfuma said, perhaps a bit too joyfully to be believed, “That’s why we’re here. So they can learn to respect the woods.”

Scorpia chuckled nervously, eyes darting between everyone. “Whooo, yup! That’s, uh, that’s us! Just connecting with the magic of the woods. Starting a conversation with the whispering part of the Whispering Woods. Just, giving it the old Junior Cadet try! That’s us! Right now!”

Entrapta was muttering into her recorder before looking at Madam Razz. “You are incorrect. I have respect for the Whispering Woods, they are a fascinating study in the ways nature can draw upon magical resources which have become much more prevalent now that She-Ra activated the heart. They are unique and one of a kind, and I’ve been working on a hypothesis for a while that they’re at least partially sentient and thus if they are unhappy with us using them to our benefit they will summon giant bugs made of first ones tech to kill us outright. ...ISN’T THAT GREAT!?”

Glimmer felt herself get a little dizzy as she looked around the tree tops, as if they would shift into an evil grin before releasing the giant bugs. Why was it always bugs and spiders with Entrapta and tech?

“Huh, yes, that too!” Madam Razz cackled, somehow slipping between Adora’s fingers like smoke. Impressive, and a little creepy. “You aren’t a bad person Entrapta, but you must remember to take all the variables into account before taking action.”

“That is correct!” Entrapta nodded with a smile, either unbothered or unaffected by a feral, time traveling, wood sorceress lecturing her on interpersonal skills.

“But you…” Razz turned again to look at Catra, squinting and quiet before her eyes went perfectly clear. “You are trying dearie, you are trying your hardest for all you pretend you don’t care. It is okay to be wrong. Failure is how we learn! It is the seeds from which we can grow into who we truly wish to be. I know you can get there! Honestly, you must learn to accept that you are not a curse!”

Catra, unlike Entrapta, was not unbothered or unaffected by the feral, time traveling, wood sorceress lecturing her. Oh no. Catra’s ears had pinned back and her breathing had gone too fast as her eyes flicked back and forth between Razz’s.

Honestly this wasn’t the call out Glimmer intended, but she’d take it. Someone had to eventually get through to her, and if Razz could batter Adora’s defenses into recognizing that her worth was more than dying for someone, then she could certainly get Catra over the last few major hurdles.

“What the hell do you know!?” Catra finally snarled, a low growl sounding from her chest.

Razz smiled as if Catra had offered her something beautiful. “More and less than you might think. But what ***do*** I know, eh? I’m just a crazy old woman!” She laughed so hard she had to wipe away a few errant tears.

And Adora sheepishly watching this whole debacle unfold started to nervously laugh alongside her. “Ha ha ha, is this- is this a good laugh or a bad laugh?”

“A good laugh this time,” Madam Razz assured before glaring at Glimmer and Catra equally, “as long as there is no wanton destruction of the woods and you ask permission first that is.”

The two turned to look at one another and Glimmer managed to not blush when they ended up far too close together, like, nose to nose close together. *Not the time or place!* Instead she turned forward again and gave her solemn vow, “We will, I promise.”

“Good, good!” Madam Razz began to totter out of the clearing without so much as a goodbye, but her muttering still floated back just loud enough to hear. “Promise what? Who was that cat?”

Everyone sort of nervously looked back and forth, startling when Melog dropped out of the branches above Catra to wind around her legs with a concerned cry and purr. Catra blinked slowly, looking down and tilting her head before hissing, “You brought her here didn’t you.”

Melog didn’t appear to say anything, their face didn’t change a bit, and yet, Glimmer was pretty sure this was the smuggest look they’d ever looked in their life.

“...thank you.” Catra ground out before wiggling out of Glimmer’s grip to pounce her companion. “Don’t you ever do that again! I can stop feeding you bacon whenever I **want** !”

The two growled, and then Melog daintily bopped Catra on the head. With one more smug huff, they sashayed away into the trees once more.

“You know what?” Catra asked rhetorically. “I changed my mind. I no longer want love, I’m evil again and I’m going to burn these woods down to take all of you out.”

“Huh, that does make a difficult dilemma.” Entrapta tapped her chin a few times. “Afterall, you have proven that you really *are* my friend, and one of my best friends. So I suppose if you’ve returned to evil I can join you.”

“...’Trapta, it’s a jo-” But Catra didn’t get to finish.

“Oooohhh,” Scorpia looked at them and then at Perfuma, practically dancing on her tippy toes with anxiety, “Oh man that is tough! Oof! Super Pal Trio reunion tour is, like, all I’ve ever dreamed of! But Perfuma-”

Perfuma giggled, waggling her eyebrows dramatically, “I can go with you! It’ll be like Lynda and Terra get to reunite!”

“Wait-” Catra clawed at her face in frustration.

“No!” Adora was red in the face and her eyes were a little watery with how upset she was before declaring, “Me and Glimmer haven’t gotten to be evil either, and we can’t all be evil! Someone has to be the good guy!”

Glimmer snickered as Catra looked at her helplessly. “Glimmer-”

“Oh no, I’m living for this. But also,” she let herself smile as evily as possible. Aiming for dastardly as she continued, “You know who isn’t here to go villain? The man responsible for this. Bow.”

Catra slowly smiled, all fangs as she nodded. “Bow, yeah, I think his majesty King Bow of Brightmoon might need a group of, uh, what are we? Not Horde right?”

“Well we’ve already got our names! So you can be, mmmmm,” Scorpia clacked her claws together before pointing at Entrapta, “Es’tra! Huh? Huh!? Pretty good right?”

“I didn’t earn my doctorate to not be called Dr. Vesselak!” Entrapta huffed, but didn’t change anything about herself as she played along...as herself with a different name. “Catra, you can be Catara.”

“Ew, pass,” Catra grumbled. “Why doesn’t Sparkles get a stupid name?”

Glimmer fluttered her eyes, “I’m the queen. Just, the evil queen now.”

Adora cleared her throat loudly, posing in what Glimmer guessed was meant to be an intimidating pose. “Hey now Ca-Catara! I, uhm, Force Commander, er, Despara demand you respect Dr. Vessel, uh, Dr. Vess-”

“Vesselak,” Entrapta supplied.

“Yes, right!” Adora cleared her throat, “Dr. Vesselak!”

"...anyone still interested in that free mercy killing?" Catra asked right as Melog dropped from the tree branches a second, somehow even more dramatic time.

And proceeded to scare the ever loving shit out of them as they had shifted to their original more humanoid form.

With none of her now evil friends willing to mercy kill, as that would be admitting there was good in them, Catara gave up quickly enough in the name of harassing their sunshine boy. Their overnight camping trip swiftly forgotten amongst the muttering about giant bugs and really over the top villain origin story monologues as they hiked back towards the castle.

Bow somehow managed to not fling himself off the bridge as he watched the whole gaggle of them march to the front door while pounding away on Perfuma's drums; and some of them managing to nail their evil laughs far better than the others. He had the grace to wait until they had surrounded him before whining, "Awwwww guys, c'mon, why don't I get to be evil?"

"Yeah, good luck with that *Kyle* ," Catra grinned viciously as he gasped.

"You take that back!"

"Nah."

Bow clenched his fist dramatically. Sinking nearly into a horse stance before slowly lifting his head. "This is my villain origin story."

Which was how Micah found himself surrounded by seven people cackling and making terribly acted threats. He smiled bright, "Well hey there sports! What game are we playing?"

Which handily ended the whole affair, and it was never spoken of again.

Chapter End Notes

Still not 100% in love with this, but how can you NOT like everyone forming and eeeeeeeevil drumming circle only for Micah Moon to destroy everyone by being unable to relate to kids?

Stop, Stop, We're Already Gay!

Chapter Notes

> This is the most shippery this fic will be getting, so please enjoy if you want that BFS poly crushing and fee free to skip if you want that good general fic goodness!
>
> For schlonze and E.N.D.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Did we make a mistake? I think we made a mistake. But what if we didn't? But what if **WE DID** ???" Adora spoke rapid fire as she paced, her getaway bag already packed and looking suspiciously like her survival bag from their failed meditative retreat last weekend.

Glimmer huffed as she jammed a crop top into her own bag, because yeah. She knew. "Nothing can be worse than karaoke! And what are you even worrying about, you've already seen her shower, have a heart for those of us who haven't!"

Adora whined pitifully before she collapsed onto the floor, somehow kicking her legs the whole way down.

Oh no. Glimmer's brain unhelpfully added. *Adora already **knows** and this is her reaction. I'm going to die.*

"Look," Glimmer stopped and squatted on the floor next to Adora's pale, but also weirdly flushed face, "We've survived worse is what I'm saying. It's fine. We're all like, super fucking queer, like so gay rainbows are jealous, and you know what that means?"

Adora's nose scrunched as she ventured, "...we don't sit in chairs right?"

"Okay, that's fair, but no. It means we're used to repressing our feelings about the people we have crushes on!"

“Glimmer, that isn’t healthy. Are you okay? Is everyone here okay?” Adora asked, as if she was not still laying on the floor being the queen of self repression.

“.....are, are you fucking with me right now?” *Please be joking, please be joking, by all that is holy and good please be joking!*

“That’s evading the question Glimmer! Who represses their feelings for their crushes? That sounds like Horde levels of stupid.”

There was a long pause as they looked at one another and Glimmer was forced to reconcile the fact that Adora had no idea she had a crush on Catra with Adora’s **massive and obvious crush on Catra** . At least *she* knew she had a crush, and weirdly enough, it did make her feel better about the whole situation.

“We’re gonna be fine,” She opted with, deciding that the only way forward was to fake it till they made it, “so get off the floor! We’re on our way to Mystacore!”

Adora groaned but rolled over and smoothly did a push up to get off the floor. Which, look, if she was going to show off , Glimmer was going to *appreciate* . Arms. Stronk. Damn!

“Wait,” Catra waved a hand as if that would stop what she’d already heard, “are you serious? That’s some Horde level bullshit.”

“Thank you!” Adora threw her hands in the air and let them fall on her face.

“And I’d know, I was the Lord of that shit!” Catra huffed. “How dare Sparkles try to make that an Alliance thing, we had it first!”

Okay, now Catra was pissed again with Glimmer, and that wasn’t what Adora had intended to do. But, like, okay.

...

Wait.

"Wait, what feelings about crushes did you repress? Catra why didn't you tell me you had a crush on someone! I thought we were best friends!" Adora whirled on her with big eyes, and definitely not a desperate need to know who Catra had crushed on in the Horde. That would be ridiculous! She wasn't jealous! Totally didn't have a massive crush she'd been dedicated to feeding and tending for her entire life! Ha! Wild!

Catra stared at her for a long time before sighing in exhaustion, "You know you are really fucking oblivious right?"

"You may have mentioned that." It was a concession but one made in the name of *getting a name* so she could, like, totally not vett them or anything. That would be super weird. Right? But not too weird, best friends and everything, that was probably part of the process. When Catra just stared at her with slowly dulling eyes Adora knew it hadn't worked.

"...is anyone-"

"If you mention mercy killing again I will tell Perfuma *and* Bow **and** Scorpia!"

"I can't fucking believe you'd betray me like this!" Catra hissed.

"I can't believe you're avoiding the question like this! Who are you, Glimmer?" Adora asked knowing full well that was a low blow. But whether she was insulting Catra or Glimmer was really dependent on the context and how the stars were aligned.

Catra gasped so loud that Entrapta looked at them from where she was riding on Emily. "Subjects appear to be having an argument, perhaps a new record seeing as we have not even left the castle."

"Entrapta!" They both yelped at the same time.

It took her a minute before she looked at her recorder sheepishly. "Sorry, I forgot the rules for the trip. Force of habit, it won't happen again. Don't worry I'm not listening to you two talk about your crushes on Glimmer!"

Adora whipped around to stare at Catra so fast her ponytail smacked her in the face. Not that she even had a single split second to entertain that particular revelation.

"I am surrounded by traitors!" Catra screeched, and Entrapta was only spared because Adora had long ago honed her 'grab Catra before she kills someone' instinct. But the wild hissing was enough for Entrapta to laugh nervously and encourage Emily to scuttle away to Scorpia and Perfuma's side.

"You have a crush on Glimmer!?" They both whisper shouted at one another from way too close. To preserve her own sanity, she needed space. So Adora opened her arms without thinking and was glad it was Catra she'd dropped instead of someone else. Because Catra daintily landed on her toes as if they'd planned the maneuver and someone else would've probably broken their tail bone.

"Look!" Catra looked around furtively before dragging Adora in close, instantly negating their previous **clear and obvious** silent pact. "We have both survived this long without an incident okay? We know she's ass over hat for Bow, so we're not *repressing, we* are being respectful which I have been told I should be. See? Everyone wins!"

Adora knew that was some faulty logic but couldn't find it in her to argue when Glimmer sashayed past them in a tight pair of shorts without a cape to hide her glorious ass and seriously blessed thighs. So instead Adora squeaked pitifully, "Yup! Definitely! We are going to be totally fine!"

"Oh stars, we're going to die aren't we?" Catra grumbled, eyes also tracking the royal assets.

But before she could say anything else, they arrived at the floating rock elevator and Glimmer cannon balled over the edge of the cliff. Adora laughed nervously and decided her best bet was to simply ignore this conversation just like she'd ignored the one this morning with Glimmer. So she punched Catra's arm and she jumped onto the nearest flying island.

It would be fine! They were gonna be fiiiiiine!

Glimmer barely saw who was at her door before yanking Catra through it roughly. "Okay, real talk, how fucked are we? Like on a scale of one to ten."

"You've literally brought her here before!" Catra grumbled. "You know the answer to that!"

Glimmer blanched. "Oh no. We're super fucked."

Catra snickered, "Well, I mean technically, we're not fucked and that's the prob-"

They hadn't been having a moment, thank you very much, but it was over all the same.

"Out!" Glimmer smacked at her her stupidly gorgeous laughing face before pushing her back out the door. "Out of my sight you gremlin!"

"Awwww, you liiiiike me!" Catra cooed and was rewarded with the door slamming in her face.

Glimmer's consolation prize was hearing her surprised squeaky yelp. That shit was *adorable* .

"So…" Bow started conversationally as Sea Hawk put the finishing touches on Bow's freshly painted nails. "How doomed are they? Are we making bets?"

Mermista and Sea Hawk made significant eye contact before looking at him pitifully.

"What?" Bow asked, starting to sweat nervously. "What!?"

"Nothing, just-" Sea Hawk didn't even get to finish.

"You need to get your girlfriend to get her girlfriends under control, and like, I knoooooow that's a tall order or whatever. But uuuuuuuuuggggggghhh, **we** are going to die."

"Girlfriend!?" Bow's voice cracked painfully. "Ha! A-ha! Ha! W-who? I don't, I don't have a girlfriend, what are you even talking about?"

"Uuuuuggggggghh!"

"There, there my dear." Sea Hawk patted at her shoulder, one hand clenched dramatically as he stared out into the distance. "We have survived worse."

Glimmer slapped her face a few times before finishing her wash off. It was fine. This was fine! She was going to be fine! It was just the unarguably three most attractive people in the universe wearing skin tight underwear who were going to be crammed into a pool with her small enough that they were going to be touching her while she was also in skin tight underwear. TOTALLY FINE.

“Hey, you okay?” Adora asked as she finished wringing out her hair. Not that Glimmer really noticed when Adora’s arms were working like that. This was cruel, hadn’t she gotten her allotted sexy muscles this morning? Somehow Adora had only gotten more jacked after the war ended and Glimmer could only assume it was done to spite her specifically. Her eyes dropped to well toned abs and legs before she could help herself.

“Yup! You’re fine! I’M FINE!” Glimmer groaned behind her hands.

Adora did not help by moving closer and giving her a **hug** like the **Horde Assassin she’d been the whole time** . “We’re gonna make it through this together.”

“What are we making it through?” Catra asked and then the world fucking ended .

Because here’s the thing. Glimmer had already seen Adora in the shorts and the crop top and DIED okay, so seeing her in the same outfit while a definite strain on her poor heart was expected. But this… Catra was not, like, super buff. Fact. Her build was slim and wiry and powerful. Also fact. Apparently she had fucking V-cut abs. Awful, awful fact. Holy fucking shit was that a water droplet rolling down the cut? What the fuck? What the *FUCK* !?

“What’s going on?” Bow asked as Glimmer’s brain attempted to reboot without just crashing again. Which was unfair because all she could see of his amazing physique was where his top crisscrossed over his back and somehow his back was the most gorgeous thing ever. But how? *He does archery.* Oh. Right.

Catra shrugged before roughly running a hand through her still dripping wet hair, somehow still missing a few strands that fell in her face in the dumbest good looking way. You’d think now that it was at that awkward phase of growing back it wouldn’t look good. You’d be wrong. “Don’t know, no longer care. We doing this or what? I did not fucking brave a shower to not get the healing relaxing I was promised.”

Okayokayokayokayokay, Glimmer looked at Adora who had turned bright red before they even hit the steam grotto and knew she had no help in this room. Time to be the queen and make decisions and stuff. “Yes! To the hot springs!”

Oh no. She’d spent enough time near Sea Hawk to start sounding like him. Her life was officially over.

Scratch that.

Bow pushed Catra, because apparently he had a death wish, into Adora’s free side (seeing as Glimmer was still delightfully tucked under her other arm) before looping his arm over Glimmer’s shoulders. Flexing as he pumped his free hand to chant scream, “Best Friend Squad!!!”

Okay. Now she was dead. Which meant that her life was over starting now. Great. Fantastic.

“Did somebody say- oof, hang on, wait- wait for it!” There was the sound of hooves sliding all over wet stones before a horn jabbed into the changing room’s cloth doorway, successfully creating a blindfold. “Swift Wind? Also, are you all wearing clothes? Because I do not need to see that. Like, ever.”

“Yeah, Best Friend Quad!” Bow cheered again before looking at Catra. “Uh, Best Friend, quintet. No, hmmm, not the ring I’m looking for.”

“He knows a squad is five people right?” Catra asked Adora.

“Sweet- wait no! Then what are we in threes and twos!? WAIT!” Bow grasped at his chest with a gasp before quickly slapping said hand over Catra’s mouth before she could interrupt him, because again he was a lucky bastard with a death wish. “Oh my goodness. Guys, do you know what this means?”

They all looked at one another, even if Catra had to bite Bow to do it.

“Ow! It, *ouch bitey* , it means that I predicted the ultimate Best Friend Squad form of FIVE of us!”

“Yeah. Wow,” Catra snarked, “you should go play the lottery today for sure.”

“Oh my gosh, you should and then we can finally finish paying off the Etherian Gaming Center! Maybe they’ll even let us go back to play the racing games!” Adora gasped, completely missing the point...or playing along. Wait. Shit, it was hard to tell when the two of them were together considering all the times they would just ride a brain wave and turn into caricatures of themselves for the laugh.

Catra snorted derisively. “Their generator. Overheated. And blew up. Because we played laser tag. Nope! We are not going back. Have Entrapta build a racing game.”

Adora whined, “But what if I want to play without death at stake?”

“Tough shit.”

Swift Wind nodded sagely, “Safety third!”

“ExCuSE mE!?” Bow squeaked.

Glimmer giggled helplessly at all of them while Catra turned and very reluctantly gave Swift Wind an air high five.

“Wooooooooow,” Mermista drawled from her tub, tail lazily flopping on the cooler stones where Sea Hawk sat with a small hand fan to keep them both at a responsible temperature, “Just, like, let me know when any of you want, like, actual safety tips.”

The Best Friend Squad looked at one another before Swift Wind snorted, “Don’t associate me with this.” His wings dramatically snapped out before he sheepishly folded them back up in order to walk without knocking anyone over, and with shaking legs walked to safety. “I’m not sticking around for the disaster show, I recommend you two get to higher ground.”

Which, while completely and totally true and fair, was also completely rude. Wait, did he really just show up to drag them and then leave? Lucky bastard.

“Safety tips? For what?” Bow looked around for the hazard nervously.

Glimmer just stared at Mermista in horror, begging her silently to not do this to them. Not that it was ever going to work but she did *try* .

“For when you need to climb out of that thirst trap.” Mermista said with an air of finality before sinking below the water.

“She has,” Sea Hawk paused dramatically, well, as dramatically as someone could while fanning themself with a neon pink fan, “personal experience.” He squawked with pain as Mermista’s tail smacked him in the gut before adding on in a ragged gasp, “From me! I-I needed the help!”

Which was somehow worse.

“...what, did you forget how to drink water?” Catra asked, somehow both caustic and curious.

Correction, now it was worse.

“HOT SPRINGS NOW!” Glimmer demanded, and it must have been desperate enough because Adora and Bow physically picked her up while Catra scampered to their reserved tub. Which gave Glimmer the perfect view of all her fur fluffing lightly as she jumped over the RIDICULOUSLY SMALL TUB (she would be having *words* with her aunt, the perfect size for three to six people her ass!) just to double back and flop behind the three of them on a steam heated stone. Glimmer, meanwhile, was placed with great care into the water and instantly flanked by Bow and Adora on either side.

Which effectively had her trapped between them and their ridiculously ripped bodies. She does not have a type, shut up!

Who was she even trying to argue with in her head!?!?!

Further addendum to the correction. **Now it was worse.**

“R-refreshing!” Adora nervously laughed but at least she relaxed a lot quicker into the water this time. Although it probably helped that Shadow Weaver was, you know, dead and not gas lighting her. Still, seeing Adora melt into the heat was both galling because it wasn’t fair that Adora got to relax first, and also triggered her brain into instant comfort and feelings of safety.

“Eh.” Catra half shrugged as her tail tip flicked around and tickled Glimmer's ear. Probably on purpose. The asshole. “Sunning is better.”

“Cat.” Adora accused.

“Duh,” Catra owned it.

“Aww,” Bow simpered.

Glimmer, meanwhile, pretended the sweat had anything to do with the naturally heated healing waters and nothing to do with touching these three sweet, stupid, beautiful, assholes. How dare they act like they weren’t all in on this together! Did Entrapta tell them? Entrapta probably told them!

In fact...hadn’t Scorpia been the one to suggest this whole hot spring trip? And her and Perfuma weren’t even here! Was Scorpia in on it too? Oh no. Was Perfuma in on it? Glimmer did not turn to glare at Sea Hawk to try and figure out just how many of them were in on the ever thickening plot to murder her. Mostly because Mermista would totally be on board with it, but also because the water really *was* relaxing. Gosh. Bow leaned and cuddled into Glimmer’s shoulder which allowed her to tilt back and to the side, effectively leaning on Adora but with her head resting on Catra’s crossed arms.

Oh wow, Glimmer blinked heavily as they all began drifting off to sleep within minutes. When did everyone get so...soothing with

their sleepy breathing? Rude. Glimmer yawned and the next thing she remembered was seeing her Aunt's smug face, and then she woke up briefly in a pile of pillows in Adora's assigned room still in a snuggle pile.

Heh.

Nice.

And with that, she finally got a good night's sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Prompts/Requests:

Schlonze
The Princess Alliance has a relaxed get together at mystacore. Glimmer and Adora manage to convince Catra to go to the steam grotto to relax with the understanding that if she gets in the water is up to her. Catra's going for the warm sleeping rocks. They all shower and change into the provided spa clothes, and are absolute gay disasters for one another.

E.N.D

Ha! This really cracked me up!!!! Since Glimmer and Adora is fuckin thirstyyyyyyy!!! What about Catra just getting dressed after a shower? Short slick backed wet hair, clear abs and muscles! Ha! Im already cracking up just thinking about it!

Don't forget to come scream with me on my tumblr!

Bow Has a Great Idea and Terrible Execution

Chapter Summary

> “I know, I just- Oooooh,” Entrapta seethed, fists shaking up and down as she bounced on her bristling hair, “That just makes me so mad! I hope war reparations get launched out of the solar system!”
>
> Catra and Scorpia squinted at one another before Catra hazarded, “Uh, don’t you mean into the sun? Like, that’s the saying right?”
>
> ~
>
> Adora chuckled nervously, “I’m pretty sure she wasn’t being literal-”
>
> “Oh no, I was.” Entrapta interrupted.

Chapter Notes

> (Teebsy) A very smart and sensible person (possibly Bow) has had the very smart and sensible idea of using leftover Horde equipment to help rebuild Etheria's farms and communities, swords into ploughshares style - repurposing tanks into agricultural tractors and construction machinery, surplus ammunition and weaponry applied to mining, road building and infrastructure projects, chemical weapon plants overhauled into factories that produce environmentally-friendly fertilizer and pesticides to help grow the first postwar harvest, etc.
>
> A less smart and sensible person (possibly also Bow) has had the well-meaning but terribly-misguided idea that, as high-profile ex-Horde members with applicable knowledge and experience, the Super Pal Trio (plus Adora) should be attached to this endeavour.

Mix the above ingredients, stir well, add creative flair, place in a preheated industrial furnace, and get to a safe distance (which in this instance should be measured in miles). Cue the inevitable results of attaching the Super Pal Trio (plus Adora) to any endeavour involving military-grade hardware and SCIENCE! Net result - lots of fire, lots of laughter (across a whole spectrum spanning Adora's nervous giggles to Entrapta's most deranged cackles), and lots of headaches for Glimmer]

~

So, not exactly what you asked for a super duper late to the party. But enjoy the Super Pal Trio plus Adora blowing up part of the Fright Zone after Bow assigned them all together. Big bouquet of whoopsie daises on his part to be honest!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora groaned as she transformed back into herself, finally the last of the big machinery had been moved for repurposing and only one tank was still waiting to be driven to the new factory location. Bow's plan had been pretty solid over all, swords into ploughshares to help restart several different industries and the economy. There was no going back to how things were, most people alive had either grown up in the war or spent the bulk of their lives in it, but everyone was finally looking forward and he'd stepped up admirably to the task. New tools, new purpose, brave new world.

The Fright Zone was being turned into an industrial center where it would help turn out the machines and technology to help the planet instead of destroy it. Technically it was Scorpia's kingdom, but she'd put it technically under Entrapta's rule, which she'd essentially left to Catra who refused to entertain the idea of it while still doing plenty of paperwork, which meant in practicality it was Glimmer's problem.

Hence, ya know, Bow.

But none of them had expected how long the clean up would go, or how far gone the Fright Zone really would be. The buildings had always been a bit crumbly and unsafe, cadets all knew which grates to jump over to avoid falling into who even knew what, and it was equally dangerous to go to the rec yards as it was to climb some abandoned smoke stacks. Somehow she'd still expected more of it to be usable. And the stuff in it was! But the infrastructure had to go. Dryl would temporarily be the industrial hub while the Fright Zone would slowly be rebuilt.

She was pathetically grateful they weren't sticking around for that portion of it.

Moons, that amount of hard physical labor sounded like torture instead of a productive way to skip the gym on the other side of a few months tear down. Sure, Bow had specifically chosen this team due to their familiarity with the layout and buildings, but Glimmer had nearly voluntold them to also rebuild in some weird bid to keep the Super Pal Trio out of Brightmoon. If she had the energy to smirk, she would've. Everyone could say *Thank You Adora* since Glimmer hadn't wanted to banish her bestie to such a horrible fate.

Adora almost flopped to the ground before remembering how disgusting the semi-polluted earth was around here, and instead accepted the water Scorpia stiffly passed her.

"Well fuck that," Catra wheezed when she finally stumbled back, "let's never do this again."

"Yeah, no. I mean, first of all, we'd have to BUILD a whole new bunch of awful bobby trapped buildings and then try to take over Etheria again before we even got to the hard part of cleaning up." Scorpia waved her claws emphatically as she spoke, almost braining Adora in the process, although Adora herself wasn't sure if that was by accident or not.

They'd just never been able to get along, which was probably a sign or something.

“We wouldn’t have to go that far,” Entrapta grumbled and put everyone on edge. When she became the voice of reason you knew something had gone wrong.

Scorpia laughed nervously, before crushing Entrapta into a side hug. “Heeeeeeeey buddy pal friend chummy chum chum, what’s up? How’re you feeling? Do you need something? I can get you those sodas and straw eyeglass thingies!”

Entrapta sighed, “I’m...non-optimal and I already drank them all. I should make a bot that can follow me to make fresh soda and snacks.”

Catra looked at Adora desperately, if the idea of a project that would allow Entrapta to gorge on baked goods and pure sugar didn’t excite her...well.

“Spill the beans, nerd.” Catra did her best to look authoritative even while her tail flicked nervously behind her. “What’s up?”

“I just...HATE this!” And like that Entrapta was pacing. Actually physically walking as her hair mimed throttling someone, and wasn’t that a terrifying thought that Adora was locking away and never considering again. “So much wasted potential! So many good bots abandoned and buildings unlooted, and do you know how much I could’ve learned about construction and architecture!?!”

Okay, yeah, this tracked.

“I hear you, but, uh, the princesses across Etheria were pretty persistent on us not going,” Scorpia began to pantomime various explosions as she cackled menacingly, “Boom! Ha ha! Victory for the Horde! Stomp our enemies! BAM!”

“Yeah, the reparations are kinda steep but,” Catra shrugged clearly struggling for a moment before awkwardly tagging on, “You’ll make better shit back in Dryl where prissy princesses can’t see it anyways.”

“I know, I just- Oooooh,” Entrapta seethed, fists shaking up and down as she bounced on her bristling hair, “That just makes me so mad! I hope war reparations get launched out of the solar system!”

Catra and Scorpia squinted at one another before Catra hazarded, “Uh, don’t you mean into the sun? Like, that’s the saying right?”

It was, Adora had overheard people using it now that they had their very own flaming ball of gas and fire in the sky. Yeeted (yote? Adora couldn't keep up with the lingo these days) through the icy cold deadness of space, into the molten hot fuck you of the sun. She’d kinda loved it, and Catra had maybe sort of had to live with her misusing it until she got it locked in.

Adora was about to confirm it when Entrapta almost comically deflated. With her energy cut out at the knees, she sunk to the ground, body uncurling until she was staring morosely into the sky. “It takes less fuel to launch things out of the solar system than into the sun. Being angry is no excuse for inefficient propellant use.”

“I never thought of it that way,” Scorpia tapped at her chin as she sat down next to the puddle of their friend.

Catra tentatively sat on Entrapta’s other side. “Okay. So how do we do that then?”

It was still surprisingly sweet to watch these three when they were being genuine and tender with one another. She almost teared up until Catra’s question finally registered. Entrapta may build and fix the spaceship(s) (there had to be secret ones by now, she knew it in her *heart*), but no one should give her this task.

Adora chuckled nervously, “I’m pretty sure she wasn’t being literal-”

“Oh no, I was.” Entrapta interrupted.

"...Okay, but hoping isn't the same thing as doing. We are **not** launching anything into the sun OR out of the solar system! Especially since we'd be launching a lot of Etherian government workers and we need them." Adora paused, hands on her hips to try and exude more authority when dealing with three people who had never respected authority in their lives. "Also, I'm She-Ra, so if you do that someone will probably complain and then I have to go interstellar to fix it. And that means Glimmer would have to approve."

Catra all but collapsed next to Entrapta with a whine. "But I *wanted* to do it! What about just the papers?"

Adora did her best to glare her down. "No."

" 'Tis the lot of the mad scientist," Entrapta sighed heavily, "great ideas just shot down because of ethical concerns and no worry about long term effects."

"Oh! Is it nap time?" Scorpia started to shuffle, clearly planning on laying down before she processed what she'd just heard. "I don't think it works like that Entrapta."

She sighed again, hair moving to cover her friend like a weirdly sentient blanket. "That's what they always say. *It doesn't work like that. No Entrapta it's just not safe, we are thinking of the long term effects though, you're not considering other people Entrapta!* Well people don't consider me either, and you don't see me rigging their tracker pads to go evil!"

Adora fidgeted a little, a bit of shame washing over her at that. She'd like to think she'd gotten better at being on Entrapta's level, their friendship had definitely improved over the years at the least. But, yeah, she'd definitely treated her friend like a child playing with a flamethrower instead of an adult with diverse interests. She made eye contact with Catra, who also looked horrifically guilty so at least there was that. Shared shame lightened the blame or something.

Adora plopped down next to them all and twiddled her thumbs before throwing out her peace offering. "Okay, so, still no off planet throwing, but...I think we can all agree this was better in theory right?" She waited for them to nod before continuing, glancing casually at their last tank "Cool. So I know one thing we **all** enjoy probably too much."

Catra was somehow twisted around so that her butt was on the ground while she had her elbows comfortably planted in the dirt. Her fingers stilled where they'd been playing with Entrapta's hair and her pupils blew out into dinner plates catching on well before she had any right to. Entrapta looked at her now purring friend before starting to grin again, and to her credit it only took another second for Scorpia to catch onto what had them both excited.

Sure, the tanks and skiffs had already been moved out of the forge and having already determined that the building was structurally unsound to be repurposed...well...the would-be fertilizer that was delivered early for rebuilding and planting was easy enough to stack. Any weapons that they could get away with having stripped the most important parts were added on top. From a distance and wearing the safety goggles that Entrapta luckily yet worryingly had for them, it was as simple as a countdown.

Catra fired the tank's cannon right as Scorpia launched a ball of lightning. The "fireworks" were **amazing** and the fire was burning all sorts of pretty colors, the four of them cheered and screamed, jumping up and down like children playing in the rain. It was so good that Adora was sure nothing could bring them down!

"WHAT THE FUCK?!" Glimmer shouted over the sound of industrial sabotage and demolition. Although to be fair, she didn't sound angry at all, more like a breathless excitement as she watched the burn.

"Oh, hello Glimmer!" Entrapta waved. "Were you supposed to help us with this?"

“Oh no, I was supposed to have a quiet afternoon and then felt the shock wave before I saw the lights.” Glimmer popped into existence on top of the tank to get a better view. “Wow, this is going to be a fucking nightmare when we get back. Don’t tell Bow, but good job folks, this is AWESOME!”

Was this going to land them in another meditative retreat plus community service? Definitely. Were they going to be in debt to someone else after they just finished paying the gaming center off? For sure.

Worth it!

Chapter End Notes

> Do I love this? Nope! I wanna launch it into the solar system!!!
>
> But I also want it to stop haunting me so I can finish writing Catra getting high on catnip :D

Entrapta Runs a Successful Experiment in Broad Daylight

Chapter Summary

Unfortunately for Glimmer's health, Entrapta has made an extrapolation from the data, and, well, she isn't wrong!

Time to pressurize the catnip.

Chapter Notes

Catnip? (KaiTheAwesomeGuy)

Excellent choice!

Glimmer was DONE, okay? She was finito'd! Finished! You could stick a fork in her and not come out with a single crumb! That fucking done! Frankly, she wasn't even sure why she'd allowed the Super Pal Trio to keep meeting up at Brightmoon knowing full well that it spelled disaster for everyone as they didn't seem to understand what collateral damage was. She could no longer care if Catra was most comfortable here in her home, she was going to start meeting her friends somewhere else! Like- like- Plumeria or-

She almost growled as she remembered the way Perfuma had giggled so cutely and serenely before telling her without a shred of humor, "They are banned from Plumeria as a group, don't ever ask me again." Glimmer had just wanted the other princesses to shoulder a bit of the responsibility and Perfuma had been such a logical choice!

Wait. Maybe she could ban the princesses who wouldn't take the property damage too? Hmmm…

Glimmer's consideration was knocked completely off course and into the void as the door to Catra's room slammed open to reveal Entrapta with her welding mask down and several very dangerous

looking power tools held in her hair. “Oh good you’re here! We can get started then!!!!”

And with that exhaustive explanation, Glimmer was hauled inside by a few silky locks of purple hair.

“Get started on what?” Catra asked, somehow perched onto a tiny ledge by one of the upper decorative windows that Glimmer herself had failed to even prop a picture frame up on many occasions.

“Wait, did we plan something?” Scorpia looked a hair panicked from the bed, where she appeared to be stuck in the feathery softness. “Shoot, I’m so sorry guys, I totally forgot about whatever it is we were planning on.”

“No no no no no,” Entrapta flipped her visor up with a manic grin, “Glimmer is just usually called when we have our quota filled, with 95% additional coverage, so I’ve already calculated her into our get togethers and look her she is just because I knew that guard was gonna crack under the pressure!”

Glimmer groaned. Yes, the guard had come running saying that Entrapta had threatened to experiment on them for “friendship science” and really she should’ve known that was bogus made up because Entrapta wanted her numbers met. After all this time you’d think she’d learn…

“That...sure is *something* of you Entrapta,” Glimmer tried to at least sound diplomatic through the eye twitches, “Please don’t threaten my guards in the future. Just ask me instead.”

Entrapta pouted a little, “But you’d say no.”

“Your point?” Oh this headache was gonna be killer wasn’t it? And Catra’s snicker fit wasn’t helping. “Shut up and get your ass down here.”

“So, so what are we- shoot!” Scorpia had valiantly almost made it to the edge of the bed without destroying it before somehow

getting re-swallowed into the feathery softness revealing only her stinger. A muffled and forcefully cheerful voice asked from the depths, “So what are we doing today?”

“Well we haven’t-” Catra started and Glimmer could only be partially grateful for Entrapta’s cackling interruption.

“Friendship science and then possibly a side experiment of- “As if finally noticing where everyone was placed, Entrapta poked at Scorpia’s stinger. “Are you comfortable like that?”

“O-oh yeah! Pffft, I’m, yup! Totally, uhm- please get me out of here!!”

While Entrapta used her hair to haul Scorpia to safety, Glimmer gleefully yanked on Catra’s tail causing her to hiss and fall from her spot.

“Bitch!?”

“Your fault for making it an easy target! Also, I told you to get down already, that thing isn’t rated for more than a few pounds. It’s for safety!” Glimmer stuck her tongue out before turning to find Entrapta watching them unblinkingly while writing. “Uhhhh?”

“Don’t stop on my account, it’s friendship science which is a lot of observational data collection. It’s not true research, more anecdotal-”

“Ants a what?” Catra muttered.

“Oh gosh are there ants in your room!?” Scorpia went up on her tiptoes for apparently no reason. “Ohhhh this is bad Wildcat, I really can’t do ants ever since I fell in that fire ant mound-”

Catra snorted but at least immediately looked guilty, so that was probably progress. ...wait.

Glimmer gasped, “Did you push Scorpia into a-?”

“SHUT UP! No! Maybe! It was an accident!”

Scorpia was carefully making her way around the room squinting at the floor to be safe before suddenly turning towards the dresser. “Is it because you’re still hoarding food in your sock drawer? That’s how you get ants, Catra, it’s like you were asking for this.”

Catra hissed, before trying to look unconcerned. “I’m not hiding-”

“Oh, blueberry muffins are my favorite.” Scorpia cheered as she ate the sock drawer muffin without a thought.

Disgusting. Glimmer wasn’t even sure that Catra washed her stirrup socks and those were on the ground. *Toe jam muffins* , her bastard brain supplied. She managed to only gag once at the thought.

“We are just learning so much together!” Entrapta shrieked, causing everyone to jump while she waved her already bursting notepad around.

“I...guess, yeah?” Catra valiantly tried with the most half-assed cheer Glimmer had ever heard.

“LOOK AT MY HANDS!” Entrapta howled, holding her gloved hands out for inspection.

Upon which, Glimmer determined that they were disturbingly rock steady.

Scorpia’s panicked look was kinda funny though when she started blabbering to fill the silence. “Wow, yup! Just l-look at her hands guys. Isn’t that amazing?”

“Fascinating.” Catra said in the same monotonous tone that several of the royal ministers somehow magically had when discussing the most boring of topics.

“AHAHA! AHAHAHAHA!!!!” Entrapta jumped up on her chair using her hair to spin at a dizzying speed. It was about this time she finally noticed the pile of what looked like soda bottles, and a few crushed energy drink cans. Oh no, she did not get paid for this shit.

“Okay,” Glimmer had seen enough. “This has been great but I’m leaving.”

“You can’t leave!” The Super Pal Trio shouted at the exact same time but for wildly different reasons.

“Look! I’ll start the other experiment right now! RIGHT NOW AND YOU CAN BE AN OBSERVER!” This was the only warning they had before Entrapta whirled her chair almost into Catra’s knees, pulled out a bottle, and sprayed her right in the face.

“ARGH!?” Catra howled, pawing at her eyes with her harshest hiss yet, which Glimmer could’ve told you she would without needing to call it an experiment (not that she still wouldn’t want front row seats to it). But then she took a deep breath in and Catra’s hands dropped. In about a second her pupils had blown out into dinner plates and her tail had poofed to maximum floof along with all her visible fur. Even her hair fluffed up, turning Catra’s head into a cotton swab.

She would have laughed if this didn’t look like Catra Zoomies Part 2: Bow Actually Kills Them This Time.

“What did you do?” Glimmer whispered in horror, only to watch Catra collapse boneless to the floor.

“WILDCAT!”

“Entrapta, did you just kill Catra!?”

“Oh no, that was a light dose of-”

“LiGhT!?” Glimmer shrieked.

“WILDCAT SPEAK TO ME!!!” Scorpia sobbed.

“-cataria; which, really, I’m as shocked as you that we’ve never-”

Glimmer slapped her own face a few times. “NO, no no ***no*** ! Go back, this is a light dose and it KILLED her!”

“Ohhh noooooooooo-ho-ho, WILDCAT, p-please I am *sensitive* you can’t do this to me!”

“-is wild considering the effects are rather relaxing-”

Glimmer shrieked, “RelAXiNG!??!? THAT SURE IS ONE WAY TO REFER TO **DEATH** !”

“-so I’ve got my timer on for that, still I thought she’d be the anxiety riddled bitey type-”

“SHE’S BLEEDING!” Scorpia wailed.

That got them all to stop, Scorpia rolled Catra’s limp body over to reveal the large wet patch of, not blood but in fact, drool that fell onto her chitin before rolling to the ground. Catra gave Scorpia’s pincer a sweet little lick, before viciously curling around it to bite and scratch, before going boneless and purring once again.

“Oh fuck,” Glimmer’s heart was going to explode, this was whiplash. Oh no, what if this was some weird double blind test where Entrapta was *actually* testing to learn what their reactions were and not Catra’s reaction to- to- “What did you give her?”

Entrapta sighed heavily, face falling before speaking painfully slowly. “IiiiIIIiiiiii took the liiiquid stiiiimuuulant and made it like air.” There was a poofing hand motion here. “By preeeeeessssurizing it- wait you know what pressurization is right?”

“Oh yeah,” Glimmer agreed with a half manic grin, still not sure if she was thrilled, terrified, horrified, or furious, “my blood pressure is doing that **as we speak** .”

“Oh good, if that’s literal let me know I’d love some readings!” Entrapta clapped her hands and apparently didn’t register the minor threat. “Then I took the caaAAAAaatniiiip and sprayed-” There was something that Glimmer could only assume was meant to be a spritzing motion- “her to facilitate- erm- to assist! Assist! The caaaaatniiiip-”

“S-she’s gonna be okay, right doc?” Scorpia asked, voice still watery as she sniffled. Apparently unconcerned with Catra flipping between trying to maul her and clinging to her like she’d hung the moons in the sky.

Which, on second thought, really *was* the only two modes Catra came in already.

Huh. Well *that* sure was something for Bow to unpack for her later. Over ice cream. Maybe chocolate milk too. And cookies. Ooh, maybe cake! God she was hungry now. *What if it’s a* ***triple*** *blind test?* No, that wouldn’t make sense? Would it? Why was Bow unpacking this again for her??

“I think I might’ve just learned something,” Glimmer muttered while rubbing at her temples.

They both winced as Entrapta cackled.

“So, uh, how long?” Scorpia motioned with her tail towards their friend. “Should I give her a sting? Just knock her right out for a night ya know.”

“No!” Entrapta and Glimmer shouted at the same time, but once again, for *wildly* different reasons.

Scorpia blushed, chuckling as she assured them, “Kidding! Totally kidding! Unless it’s not a big deal, then I wasn’t, but otherwise it was totally a joke shared between friends, by me to you. My friends! A funny little ha ha!”

Catra twitched and yawned, curling up half in Scorpia’s lap at this point and fell asleep, which no Glimmer was not JEALOUS okay?

Catra had scratched Scorpia deep enough that she'd need to buff. So this was fine. Peachy! Right, this was what Bow was going to "alk your feelings out guy" for her.

"I'm leaving," Glimmer informed them, no longer caring why she'd been there in the first place. In fact, she couldn't remember why she'd been here to ride their asses anyways. Time to go. She teleported out and couldn't even care that she absolutely saw Entrapta capturing some sparkles in a tube.

Bow sighed when she arrived with ice cream, but at least he powered down his tablet. "They're alive, I think. Entrapta almost killed me by killing Catra by not killing her for an experiment. *Shut up and eat your strawberry ice cream Bow!* "

Catra takes things too far

Chapter Summary

> The floor is cishet lava and the dam to the room broke, someone was going to have to make the ultimate sacrifice and it sure as fuck wasn't going to be Glimmer.

Chapter Notes

> Weirdoughnut, for some reason I had your name at this top of this chapter's draft with a link to your tumblr.
>
> I don't think you actually requested this but here you go anyways????????

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Ma’am, please come down. You have meetings today.” Juliette called gamely from the doorway, safe from the horrible fate that had befallen her queen.

But Glimmer wasn’t about to **lose** to Catra of all people! “NEVER!”

“...I’m getting your aunt.”

It was almost enough for Glimmer to suffer the humiliation, but not enough. Bow squeezed the pillar tightly with legs, pausing his attempt to rig up some rope to make the waiting more comfortable, in order to pat her thigh in support.

Look, it had started so simply- or, well, as simply as anything with the Super Pal Trio did. Okay, so it started like this:

Scorpia nodded slowly as she tried to work through their daily quota, “So you want to see if you’re faster at climbing than Entrapta, but Trapta called it off?”

Catra was sulking by the pillar, leaving Entrapta to explain. “Because, if she wins she’d be an egocentric asshole, and if she loses she’s going to be a major fucking sore loser!”

And, upon hearing Entrapta’s reasoning, Catra, being a fucking major sore loser, looked like she was ready to pull the nearest portal lever before she smiled sweetly. “You know that game you wanted to play last week, the floor’s lava?”

Begrudgingly curious, Entrapta nodded. “...yeeesss?”

Already up off the floor, Catra had cheerily declared, “The floor is cishet.”

This was around the time that a guard had found Glimmer and warned her the Super Pal Trio was doing *something* in the ballroom, effectively ruining her day.

Glimmer listened to their stupid story and huffed, “That is the dumbest shit I have ever heard.”

This had proven to be a fatal mistake on her part, because all it did was provoke her best frenemy to sneer down her nose as she came up with a plan.

“Oooooh,” Catra mocked, “big words from a grounded, short-”

No. No! Catra wouldn’t...oh moons Catra absolutely fucking would that bitch!

“DON’T YOU FUCKING-”

“STRAIGHT CIS WOMAN!”

Glimmer cursed and teleported her and Scorpia to be on the nearest consol table, while Entrapta shrieked and scaled the same pillar as their cackling EX-friend. Glimmer howled, “You can’t just declare that without warning motherfucker!!!”

“We play with one step rules,” Entrapta explained, letting her hair do the heavy lifting of keeping her off the floor. “We warned you, and the next step you took got you off the floor. It’s fair-ish sometimes, AND it means you are not the cishet.”

Catra cackled, already climbing higher, as she suddenly realized how to bend this situation to her benefit. “The dam broke, the cishet level is rising! Sucks to be SHORT and close to the ground.”

Entrapta gasped and scurried for a second before asking, “Wait, how quickly? Which dam are we using for reference?”

“Uh-”

Wrong fucking answer.

“Oh no,” Entrapta supplied her own worst case scenario, “I bet it’s like the Hortian! One thousand gallons a second!!!!”

“NO!” Scorpia gasped in horror, before asking, “Wait, how quick is that?”

“Imagine one thousand chickens appearing every second-”

Say no more, Glimmer and Scorpia began their grim ascent up their own pillars. The four of them climbed silently, only ever stopping to check the lava chicken level via Entrapta somehow knowing the exact size and volume of the room they were in. They nearly reached the ceiling before Entrapta called out, “We can stop now, thanks to the impractical number of water fountains in Brightmoon-”

“It’s not!” Glimmer wasn’t even sure why she was defending their impractical number of water fountains, but now it was a pride thing so Entrapta was going down.

“-which means that the lava was already flowing out a little and cooling, causing that wall to break open and now the flow has equalized and it can’t get any higher.”

Catra huffed, digging her claws in at the same time Scorpia slid a little down the pillar with a squeak. “What, so we’re just stuck here!?”

“Until someone admits to being cisgender and heterosexual, yes.” Entrapta huffed, before pulling out her recorder, “SPT BBP log entry 342, I find myself confused as to why I am frustrated with the circumstances I find myself in: playing the worst version of the floor is lava I’ve ever heard of. I believe that Catra is running a social experiment of her own, which should make me proud, but at what cost?”

“Hey!” Catra growled. “How dare you, I’m not!”

“You-”

“Your majes...ty?” The guard at the door looked around before looking up at them. “Ah. I’ll send word to the Techmaster.” And

with that they managed to skillfully wash their hands of the situation and pass the buck. Rude! Why hadn't she thought of that? Glimmer wiggled a little to hug onto the pillar tighter.

Of course, the guard's ploy hadn't worked so well at all so at least she could soothe herself with that thought.

Bow sighed as he walked in, "Guys, really? Can we *please* have one normal week where we don't-"

Catra pointed one claw casually towards the ground, "Floor's cishet lava and the level's about 4/5ths of the way up."

Bow squeaked, jumping in the air and shooting a grappling hook arrow so quickly it made Glimmer's head spin and heart do something funny. He grabbed the line and used his incredible core strength to keep his legs parallel to the floor to stay off it as he skillfully climbed. Really he should thank her for all the years he climbed up the back way to her bedroom window. After reaching Glimmer he asked in the most serious tone she'd ever heard. "Who declared it?"

"Oooooh, someone's in trouble!" Catra jeered before tilting her head sheepishly. "I don't know why I said that. It's me. I'm in trouble."

"Catra! How could you!?" Bow demanded, carefully dashing the furious tears from his eyes.

Stars and moons, she loved this man.

"Has the…" The same guard (probably? Hard to tell with the whole body covering thing) stared up at them with a sigh. "I'll...fetch She-Ra."

"Wait, don't-"

Which is how Adora, fully transformed, ran into the room with her sword drawn before squinting up at them in confusion. Glimmer, stupidly, made eye contact with Catra and instantly surrendered any sanity she had left. She called down, "Floor's cishet lava!"

"GLIMMER!" Bow shouted at the same time Adora jumped literally from the floor up to ceiling to hang tight.

Glimmer pointed an accusing finger and squeezed with her thighs for her very life, "Catra declared it!"

Adora looked heartbroken as she cried, "CATRA!?"

Catra hissed weakly at her, but even if she clearly hated the situation she'd created, there was no getting her to admit to it. For a few minutes everyone simply stewed in aggravated silence, trying to decide if the teasing would be worth it until the guard returned, then left, then came back with her General.

Juliette's request had been issued only once from the safety of the doorway and now she was getting Aunt Casta, and could this day get any worse!?

"-and why aren't they coming down?" Speak of the knitting devil and she will come.

Juliette sighed heavily, "Ma'am…"

Adora broke first, too nervous about how this must look to stay quiet, "It's Catra's fault!"

"I AM BEING ATTACKED!?" Catra shrieked.

Juliette grumbled, and the only reason they heard her response was due to the horrible (or possibly great, Glimmer needed to remember the acoustics of this particular ballroom for the future) way her voice bounced off all the marble. "The floor was declared cishet ma'am."

Castaspella, who had already strolled into the danger zone, turned pale. Glimmer closed her eyes in defeat. She may not enjoy her aunt's exuberance, but she didn't have to be hung out to dry for them like this. It was cruel. It was unusual. It was-

"Why didn't you lead with that!? That is a **sacred tradition** !" Castaspella gasped, leaping onto the nearest chair before

theatrically gasping again. “Oh no, did the dam break!?”

Bow, who had already thrown his rope down, waited for Casta to step into the foot loop he made before hauling her up. “Yes, the room is basically done for.”

“Get me up quicker! Glimmer, help him!” Casta shouted, looking wildly around as if she could find the invisible water line.

But this was too much. Adora laughed weakly, looking at all of them clinging onto various pillars and rafters. “I guess...someone has to do it, don’t they?”

“Adora, don’t you dare-”

“We can’t all stay up here forever Catra, someone has to make the sacrifice, and it should be me.”

“Why does it always have to be you!?”

Glimmer and Bow looked at one another in horror as Catra’s voice broke. Holy shit was she crying!?

“Because I’m She-Ra.” Adora tearfully whispered. “Protecting Etheria is what I *choose* to do.”

“Adora, please, not like this!”

Entrapta’s hair reached across the gap to offer them a small container of popcorn. Glimmer did not want to know where she’d been hiding it, but Bow had always been a stress eater and he began to feverishly demolish the offering.

“Then who’s going to do it? No one should have to, and I won’t let you get hurt. See?” Adora was full on crying now. “It *has* to be me.”

“No it doesn’t! We can wait it out, we can wait for someone to walk in and take the fall”

“I’m so sorry.”

“Adora, please, just this once, stay!”

Scorpia nudged Glimmer’s shoulder to stage whisper, “They do know it’s just a game right? It won’t make anyone actually turn cishet? And even if it did, like, that it’s really not the end of the world, ya know?”

Glimmer sniffled, fighting back tears of frustration, “No. They’re such fucking idiots.”

“EMILY NO!” Entrapta shouted as her bot teetered into the highly polished ballroom, her legs sliding out from under her and scuffing the wax job horrifically. “Emily...Emily, I’m sorry, the floor is cishet lava.”

The bot looked down with alarm, then back up at them with what Glimmer could only define as determination and then, slowly and very dramatically, took another step after being informed of the lava. Her metal leg clacked as she collapsed theatrically, light fading from her display unit as she made the ultimate sacrifice. And then immediately turned back on and beeped something cheerfully as Entrapta slid down the pillar to hug her.

“Yeah, your lava death was very convincing, great job!” Emily wiggled in place as Entrapta began to pet her. “Who’s a good girl? Who’s the goodest girl in the whole wide world? Yes you are!”

Glimmer glared at the claw marks Catra left behind as she gracefully slid to the floor, and then seethed as Adora just jumped down, landing hard enough to crack the floor tiles. And then luckily caught Scorpia as she finally lost her grip and fell, cracking a new section of the floor under their combined weight. Glimmer felt her eye twitch dangerously, still holding her spot high above them all to survey the damages from this stupid game. Lesser than others in expense, but greater in mental stability. Damn them all!

Aunt Casta laughed in delight, “Oh this was so much fun! The drama! The excitement! I’m going to make us all matching sweaters. What size is the robot?”

“Bow.” Glimmer must have looked particularly ragged as he saluted and moved to talk with her aunt. Then she teleported just above Catra to drop, elbow first, on her. “YOU ARE FIXING ALL THIS DAMAGE!”

“ACK!??!?”

Which was how the two of them ended up fixing the damages together thanks to her little maneuver causing additional tiles at the edges of the crack to splinter like dry rotted wood. Because faced with a day or two of labor or 8 hours trapped in their get along shirt, Glimmer and Catra had an understanding. Never again would that shirt be used.

The royal missive went out to castle residents afterwards, regrettably banning the floor is lava on castle grounds.

Chapter End Notes

> And that's the last of the chapters I had planned for this! Have something you want to see? Prompt me in the comments or over on my tumblr nny11writes.tumblr.com

Double Trouble Gets Bored

Chapter Summary

> Double Trouble has heard all the amazing tales of drama and theatrics that the Super Pal Trio get into these days, but bored out of their gourd after a whole day of normalness, they seek out some entertainment elsewhere.
>
> In a weird twist, this chapter doesn't feature the SPT.

Chapter Notes

> I played myself and obsessedLilShit caught me, so this one's for you!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer had actually been having a shockingly nice day doing her regular royal duties, and had been determined to tackle that pile of paperwork if it killed her or she threw it in a fire and claimed it never arrived, whichever came first. It was normal, banal, passable, the kind of day you could have and forget everything about by the next morning. Again, very VERY nice.

She really should've known better than to want nice things.

Glimmer shrieked and teleported away from the door as it slammed open, summoning her staff mid teleport to bash a bad guy only to find Bow dramatically posed against it. He had most of his weight supported into one bent leg, the other was kicked out straight while his arms trailed along the doorframe above him.

“Glimmer! It’s too late for me, but I had to warn you!” Bow staggered forward and collapsed into her arms. His eyes slipped closed as he mumbled, “I had to warn you…”

In a completely, definitely, totally calm voice, one filled with grace and dignity, she asked gently, “What!? OF WHAT!? **Bow what the fuck!?** ”

He reached up to clutch at the back of her neck, and one yellow-green eye cracked open at her. “That the Super Pal Trio is really *boring* !”

She did not feel bad dropping Double Trouble like a sack of potatoes, in fact they should really thank her for having learnt enough self restraint to not murder them for this.

“Ow! Is this anyway to treat an honored guest?” A wave of sparkling black magic rolled over them, leaving their preferred form behind with a pout. “I was promised drama! I was promised theatrics! I was-”

Glimmer’s brain finally surfaced from desperately singing *woke up today, I chose violence* to register the words coming from their mouth. “EXCUSE YOU! Boring???? Are you kidding me? They’ve caused more property damage now that they’re on our side than when they were shooting cannons at us! Last week Catra got us all stuck in the rafters, and you come here, to me, on this beautiful normal day and say they’re boring?”

Double Trouble rippled again, and "Catra" was left laying on the floor groaning and scratching at their face. "Ugggghhhhhh! That was *last* week, and today we're just sitting around talking. And Catra's teaching them to play a card game I taught her. This is the worst, and an emergency, and you need to do something about it as the queen!"

Her eye twitch, which had been blessedly absent today, returned full disgusting force along with a tension headache. "And Catra put up with you for a year!?"

"Wow, you *are* rude, aren't you? Didn't your mommy teach you better?"

Her teeth almost cracked under the pressure. "You don't get to talk about her. ***Ever*** ."

Double Trouble winced, a genuine flash of guilt skittering across their face before they stood and brushed imaginary dust off themself. "My apologies."

It was absolutely bizarre to hear those words in Catra's voice, and Catra apologizing over her mom was NOT something she wanted to think about ever again thanks. "Can you-" They returned to their own body but wore a new outfit consisting of a vest with multiple cut outs and booty shorts with "juicy" on the ass. Their unnecessarily tall golden stilettos was just an unfair advantage over every height challenged person in Brightmoon. And they called her rude!

“So!” Double Trouble clapped their hands together, smiling small and bright. “What are we going to do to liven up this sad charade?”

“We!?”

But they were already pacing around her room, making minor tweaks to their outfit and hair as various inspirations hit. “I heard that fire and explosions are kind of their thing-”

“WE are not going to encourage them to-”

“-but where’s the fun in that? I’m thinking espionage!” This came with jazz hands for no apparent reason, causing even more dread to curl in her stomach.

“-and if I even see her near one of those fire bombs I swear I’ll-”

“Maybe start with a fun little dinner to lower their defenses-”

“Oh stars, and if THAT happens Bow will never forgive me and-”

“-and perhaps a nice cabernet sauvignon, although you look like an ice in her chardonnay sort of basic-”

“FUCK YOU!?”

“It’s the truth! Let me guess, sparkling white wine or a sweet rose?”

“...fuck you.”

“Gotcha bitch,” they winked and blew her a kiss. Apparently finished planning their devious schemes and their outfit, Double Trouble did a little twirl. “So I’m thinking we should do this tonight, when the song birds fall silent among the purple hues of the forest.”

Glimmer took a moment to do what felt like mental math, her oldest nemesis, before hazarding, “...so at about seven?”

Double Trouble pouted but still nodded. “Yeah, about seven. Honestly, where is your sense of wonder and magic, your majesty?”

“Sorry, but we’re actually meeting with Stonedar and Rokkon who want to talk trade with the Rock People.” Glimmer did her best to not look too excited about this little nugget of information. It was true and correct, but if she even looked a hair happy Double

Trouble was likely to claim she lied. And stars above was she happy to have a reason to deny them anything. “And as my Royal Advisor and a hero of Etheria, Catra is required to be there, so the Super Pal Trio will split up before then.”

“...well I can at least spend time with-”

“And Scorpia has a date tonight with Perfuma, since Catra wasn’t available, and I think Entrapta is hanging with the clones.” Glimmer felt years of her life being added back into her soul as their face twisted into a comically large frown. “Don’t even think about sneaking into the dinner either, or I will sentence you to assist the clones in fixing the spires communications arrays.”

Double Trouble gasped, clutching at their (added just for dramatic effect) pearls. “You wouldn’t!”

She smirked, putting all her weight onto the balls of her feet like they were going to fight one another. “Oh, but I would. I’ve made Catra clean half this castle. I made Scorpia sit quietly for an hour to contemplate her actions. I banned Entrapta from having her tracker pad on castle grounds.” Glimmer advanced, threateningly in every step as her fists clenched and lit with magic. Double Trouble’s ears fell and eyes widened in fear as she listed her sins one by one. “Frosta had to hold court for all trades for a day. I banned Netossa from playing games in Brightmoon for a month. I made Bow be the bearer of bad news!” Double Trouble took one step at a time backwards, keeping the distance between them until their shoulders hit the bookshelf behind them. “I made Adora take a **week-long vacation** !”

They blinked up at her, having either shrunk or slid down the tightly packed books behind them, with wavering tear filled eyes and hissed, “You’re a monster!”

“No.” She pulled herself upright, and let the barest hint of magical wings shine behind her, blocking out the light from the room. “I’m the Queen of Brightmoon!”

“Noooooooooooo!” They held an arm out for protection, the other went over their eyes, and then they popped to stand back upright at their full towering height with a clap and giggle. “And *scene* ! You know, this is the most fun I’ve had this whole time. I’ll have to come back to visit you personally sometime queenie, I’d love to watch you sentence people to such a pretty and petty tune! Brava, really!”

And with that they sashayed out of the room, leaving Glimmer behind feeling totally lost. Then with a sudden rush of dread she ran to the still open door to scream, “DON’T YOU DARE!?”

Right into Stonedar’s unamused face.

Gods. DAMMIT.

Chapter End Notes

Want to read more? Prompt me in the comments or leave me an ask over on my tumblr nny11writes.tumblr.com!

I 100% **will** latch onto your ideas, and that is a threat. :D

Glimmer Writes Up the Rules

Chapter Summary

> Glimmer can try to write the rules down all day long. Catra will find a way to rope the Super Pal Trio into breaking them.
>
> (From tumblr prompt game, shout out again to Tipsy for feeding the beast!)

Chapter Notes

> You can check out the other two short fics on the original tumblr post. :)

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer had been very proud of herself. It was actually *very* mature of her you see. Some might even say, regal and royal behavior. Responsible. Yes, she'd thought to herself nodding serenely. Responsible.

Responsible, she'd reminded herself even when the headache started as she gave the scroll to the super pal trio.

Responsible, she'd demanded of herself when she'd noticed the pattern.

"Oops," Catra drawled, shrugging her shoulders in the least apologetic manner humanly possible, "Our bad!"

Scorpia smiled brightly, but the small bead of sweat at her temple was a dead give away.

"What was our bad?" Entrapta asked, hanging upside down and fully tangled in the wires of the war room's ceiling.

Responsible, she reminded herself firmly and held up one finger before summoning her water glass to herself to buy a moment of

peace. Which miraculously did not break in her hand when Catra snorted.

"Are-" Glimmer stopped herself. Refused to finish that sentence. Mature. Queenly. Responsible. "This idea of yours was… sure *something*, but as clearly stated in the rules I gave you you three were not to mess with anything in this room while unattended!

"Oooooh, is *that* what that meant?" Catra asked, over acting her part and delighting in being a little shit of massive proportions.

Fuck it, she was gonna say it. "Are you seriously this fucking stupid, or can you not read, or what?????"

Catra crossed her arms as she hunched in, losing her grin. "Shut up, Sparkles! Just because some of us didn't have royal educations with fancy shit like reading doesn't mean you get to be mean."

And for a moment Glimmer felt like the scum of the planet, just the lowest of jerks who punched down when anything happened to annoy her.

And then she remembered all the thousands of times she'd literally seen Catra reading.

"YOU READ THOSE REPORTS OUT LOUD TO ME LAST WEEK!?!?!??!"

"Did I?" Catra asked, clearly trying to find a way to wiggle out of this one before giving up on her little charade. "Still, you should think before you throw around insults like that. You could've hurt someone's feelings for real!"

"Yeah!" Scorpia said, clearly meaning to just back up her friend regardless of the situation. Except now everyone was looking at her to see if she had anything more to say and she looked like the world's most pathetic creature. Like a wet dog trying to fade

through the soil below their feet to vanish and never be seen again. “Well, you could’ve.”

“I mean, that’s fucking fair, I guess.” She grumbled. “Now let’s focus on the fact that this is the fifth-”

“Wasn’t this the sixth one on the list?” Entrapta asked, somehow now inside the holoprojector in the table. Her voice somehow was muffled but almost squeaky sounding.

“Hang on,” Catra pulled the scroll **that Glimmer gave them** out of her pocket and opened it with a flourish. “Huh. You’re totally right, we skipped number five on accident.”

“Skipped it. On…accident?” Glimmer looked at Scorpia who nodded happily.

“Yeah, we figured it was a streamlined process, you know.”

“Also I *really REALLY* wanted to get my hands on all this tech!!! I mean, with just a few tweaks the proficiency-”

“NOPE!” Glimmer whirled around, teleporting in to grab Entrapta before teleporting back out to grab Catra who she knew would reflexively grab Scorpia for her. “NOT TODAY!”

She quickly teleported them all out to the hill two miles outside the city and dumped them on the fresh, soft grass waving on top of it. The last thing she heard before leaving was, “Excellent work team-”

“I didn’t finish my project?”

And then she got her hour of peace, facilitated by cake and a healthy pour of chocolate milk.

Chapter End Notes

I've still got these two ideas that I swear I am going to write eventually for this fic:

1. There's ~~writing~~ paint on the wall
2. A two woman rat pile

But if there's other stuff you'd like to see please feel free to prompt me here or on my tumblr!

There's Writing on the Wall...no wait, that's paint

Chapter Summary

> Okay, so, this is not really like the other chapters in this fic. It's not fun zany fluff. It's really subdued angst with a dash of comfort and fluff.
>
> Just, full disclosure in case you see this update and are very excited for a fun time!
>
> Anyhow, the Super Pal Trio decide to try "art therapy" and it gets a little too real.

Chapter Notes

> As requested by the loverly sometipsygnostalgic, another fun prompt that I somehow made more depressing but I'll actually post this one! :D

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Glimmer really hadn't been sure what to expect when the guards had found her, looking so forlorn that even the feathers from their helmets drooped as they informed her that the Super Pal Trio was doing… *something* .

"Something?"

"Vandalism." One guard confirmed grimly.

"A mural?" The other guard asked cautiously.

The two turned to glare at one another, somehow having a conversation only through the rapid tilting of their helmets, before looking at her again. "They're drawing on the walls."

Despite wanting to stomp down there like a child and berate them for acting like children themselves, Glimmer instead opted to be calm and collected.

And, honestly, she was kinda grateful she'd been quiet in her approach for once, as it allowed her to silently observe what the SPT were doing this time. And she could understand the confusion a little.

The wall in question had been somewhat neatly divided up between the three of them, as each worked feverishly at their own art. On one section of the wall was a very large and ever expanding collection of black stick figures on a haphazardly painted white background that Scorpia was adding more onto with the most serious face Glimmer had ever seen. In the middle Catra was literally throwing splashes of paint in a riot of mismatched colors, her eyes wide and blown out as her chest heaved for air. And on the final section was what could only be described as a geometric nightmare where Entrapta stood with her mask down painting in very fine controlled lines that looked nothing like the doodles Glimmer had become familiar with.

It was kind of a gut punch really.

"...are you all okay?" Glimmer asked carefully. She wanted to just be mad but none of them looked like they were having a particularly good time as they worked.

In fact, Catra's response was to startle badly and then slash the wall in front of her, effectively removing the darkest of the paint splashes with four clean cuts while Entrapta winced silently next to her.

"Yes." Scorpia answered. Her voice was soft and quiet, smooth and authoritative. It actually freaked Glimmer out *more* that Catra's outburst. Scorpia glanced at her over her shoulder but didn't stop painting. "We're just…quota, you know? Can you hit us with the punishment later?"

Entrapta made a sound that was half sob and half growl as she began to paint over parts of her current creation using bright greens and whites and blacks and nearly glowing purples. Erasing what Glimmer realized looked almost like faces with more mechanical looking objects.

"That's fine, just, not sure if a punishment is needed. What were you doing?" Glimmer quickly moved towards the only person who seemed cognizant in the moment and curiously eyed Scorpia's work now that she was closer.

It seemed to be a series of moments from Scorpia's own life. Scenes that Glimmer didn't know the context of but their almost childlike style somehow knocked the air right out of her lungs. Two women holding a small child. A large man on his knees. Scorpia alone in a large, sad room. There were happy moments too, scattered throughout the rest but it was hard to find them through all the messy black lines.

"Painting. Entrapta said it could be therapeutic, you know? And at first we were just goofing around, having some fun and…I dunno. I just wanted to express myself more, Perfuma's always reminding me that I can and should take up space. And it's not like I really get the chance to do stuff like this that often. Entrapta wanted to experiment with art therapy, I guess Hordak had mentioned it to her? And I think Catra was really just in it for the petty crime. But then we just started treating it more seriously, and then it kind of was serious." Scorpia paused, moving again to draw her own little stick figure on bent knee in whatever space she could find squished between the rest. "I think this was good for us. We all needed it."

Glimmer winced, because yeah. The reality of running a queendom full of traumatized people was constantly finding new ways to try and help people find outlets and heal. She took a small step back and then walked across the way, skipping Catra as she growled.

Entrapta's geometric shapes were slowly forming into some sort of mangled machine now. A few purple gems like the ones she'd seen Hordak wear around the castle were scattered throughout although many seemed misshapen. The things she saw cover faces before had turned into cogs and springs and all sorts of bits and bobs, and on closer inspection many of them still held traces of the faces. It was cold and detached, but also burning with…she wasn't sure? It was disquieting. Glimmer tilted her head in case that magically helped her understand better. Entrapta, for her part, finally stopped and stepped back showing the glowing red center; both a gem and a furnace with tendrils extending in jagged bolts. Glimmer nodded, recognizing at least part of it. Entrapta stared up at her painted machine, shuffling back to stand next to Glimmer.

Scorpia stopped, her brush leaving a large line as she yanked her claw back and quickly moved to look at her friend's art. There was a long pause before Scorpia looked at Entrapta, and seeing whatever she was looking for, leaned in and added something. When Scorpia stepped back with a smile Glimmer could see seven figures. One robot, one cat, and five people surrounding what could only be Entrapta herself raised up on her hair.

Entrapta moved and wrapped around Scorpia in a hug at the same time that Catra finally stumbled away from the wall as well.

Catra was no longer growling, eyes less glazed over and more just tired as she did a double take at Glimmer's presence. After a moment she moved aside fully and let them all see her work better.

It was abstract, but there was no missing the amount of pain that bled from every drop of paint. Glimmer was sure she wouldn't forget the way Catra looked with paint literally dripping off her claws. There was nothing definitive, all the colors matching and contrasting. It was just pure emotion slapped onto the wall.

"I think I'm done too," Scorpia said, nodding meaningfully to Catra who jerked about to look at the stark expanse of Scorpia's

memories.

Catra paused before lifting her hands, finger painting in a happier memory with the brightest colors literally on hand. It was Scorpia laying with her head in Perfuma's lap (Glimmer was pretty sure it was Perfuma, there was a flower in her hair at least), and when she finished it popped out brilliantly amongst the rest. She moved on to add a few more colors to a few of the other happier memories until she ran out of colors she liked. When finished Catra walked silently over to her friends and flicked her tail towards her own section.

Entrapta let go of Scorpia to look at Catra's piece more closely, painting in bright white and red lines showing where the colors underneath accidentally made triangles, right angles, and many other shapes. She didn't complete any, not fully, adding just enough straight lines to draw the eye in before she stepped back, letting Scorpia wrap one arm around her as the other pulled Catra into her side as well.

Holy shit. It was beautiful, there were all beautiful art pieces that Glimmer wanted preserved in the Royal Archives forever. Maybe she should try art therapy? Or, well, whatever this actually was? *Think about it later!*

"Do you want to leave it up?" Glimmer asked quietly, afraid to somehow break the silence.

Scorpia gave both women a small squeeze before replying for them all, "No. It was just for us, you know? We'll cover it back up. Do you want any color in particular for this wall? Same blue as before?"

Glimmer felt a small tug at her heart and wished she could convince them to leave it. She swept her eyes up and down, noting the paint spills and dots along the hallway before coming up with an idea. "What if I commissioned you instead? You could do a mural here. …I'll even pretend I didn't approve so it can have that smack of illegality you three seem to like."

Scorpia once more checked on her friends before nodding slowly, "Yeah, we could do that. Tomorrow. For now, can you…?"

Glimmer quickly used her magic to cast an illusion and the wall appeared to be miraculously blank to anyone who might look at it.

"Thank you."

It took them three days to first cover over their previous work and then come up with an idea before finally putting any brushes to work. The three of them proudly presented their mural to Glimmer in the dead of night, because what self respecting vandal would let someone see their crime in broad daylight? A bad one, that's who.

Glimmer did not mention the fact that they were not, in fact, vandals. It was better to let them have their fun. This time at least.

The mural was of them. All of their friends too. The whole of the Princess Alliance in Glimmer's mind these days. Of course the core princesses, scattered throughout the group. Catra and Melog, Hordak and Wrong Hordak, Emily and Emily's Kid Sister, even Mr. Pop and Mrs. Baker waved from the background where Double Trouble Was dramatically slumped. The group was smiling, either at one another or towards the viewer with only Castaspella concentrating closely on her knitting.

Weirdly, it reminded her of the official art her mother had commissioned for her generation, but only in the fact that it was so different.

Spinnerella and Netossa's images from the gems and carved stone were beautiful and distant. Faceless profiles of rulers and their powers. Here they stood with arms wrapped around one another, laughing away. A riot of colors and warmth, only made better in her mind because they weren't perfect like the professionally done embossings.

Glimmer could tell she was literally sparkling a little as she grinned up at it.

"I love it." She smirked a little as she added on, "And now I don't have to properly pay someone else."

"Thanks," Catra's smile was a little too genuine to match the tone of her voice, "But you said you'd commission us. So what **are** you paying us with? Our weight in gold? Fancy outfits? Don't say a party."

"Cake and ice cream okay? We can even have some tea." Glimmer waved for them to follow her to the kitchen.

But Catra was still following her towards the kitchens. "Whoah-ho, don't go busting out the big bucks for us Sparkles, someone might take advantage!"

"Oh, I would love some snickerdoodle ice cream with mine!" Scorpia cheered far too loudly for the time of night. "Or, what kind of cake is it, vanilla? Chocolate? Oh I love surprises! I'll mix and match a little once we get there! I'm thinking a nice decaf black of some kind, and a moist piece of cake? Ah! That sounds perfect."

"As long as I can carve it into cute animal shapes I'm good with whatever," Entrapta confirmed, hair already pulling out her miniature tea set for use.

"I'm lactose intolerant." Despite being the first on board, Catra now realized everyone else was happy and on board so she had to be contrarian somehow.

"Shut up and eat your damn cake." Glimmer commanded as she unlocked the door.

The chefs forgave them for their late night raiding after seeing the painting on the wall.

Chapter End Notes

Did I spend too much time describing Entrapta's art? Probably, and I'd do it again!

Next time we'll be back to our regularly scheduled shenanigans.

End Notes

Here's the dealio y'all:

Send me your favorite words/scenario prompts and I will work them into this as much as possible! Nothing off limits, this is crack folks, hit me.

Check out this fan art from Ch5 by Suricata-Passer on tumblr!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!